ENTERPRISE SURVEYS

INDICATOR DESCRIPTIONS

July 24, 2026

IFC International Finance Corporation World Bank Group

http://www.enterprisesurveys.org
enterprisesurveys@worldbank.org

ABOUT ENTERPRISE SURVEYS

The Enterprise Surveys focus on the many factors that shape the business environment. These factors can be accommodating or constraining for firms and play an important role in whether a country will prosper or not. An accommodating business environment is one that encourages firms to operate efficiently. Such conditions strengthen incentives for firms to innovate and to increase productivity—key factors for sustainable development. A more productive private sector, in turn, expands employment and contributes taxes necessary for public investment in health, education, and other services. In contrast, a poor business environment increases the obstacles to conducting business activities and decreases a country's prospects for reaching its potential in terms of employment, production, and welfare.

The Enterprise Surveys are conducted by the World Bank and its partners across all geographic regions and cover small, medium, and large companies. The surveys are administered to a representative sample of firms in the non-agricultural formal private economy. The universe of the survey, also known as the population, is consistently defined in all countries and includes the entire manufacturing sector, the services sector, and the transportation and construction sectors. Public utilities, government services, health care, and financial services sectors are not included in the universe. Uniform universe, uniform methodology of implementation, and a core questionnaire are the basis of the Global methodology under which most Enterprise Surveys have been implemented since 2006.

The Enterprise Surveys collect a wide array of qualitative and quantitative information through face to face interviews with firm managers and owners regarding the business environment in their countries and the productivity of their firms. The topics covered in Enterprise Surveys include infrastructure and climate, trade, finance, regulations, taxes, corruption, crime, informality, competition and public procurement, innovation and technology, jobs and workforce, gender, dispute resolution, management practices, and perceptions about obstacles to doing business. Please refer to the World Bank Enterprise Survey (WBES) questionnaire.

The qualitative and quantitative data collected through the surveys connect a country's business environment characteristics with firm productivity and performance. The Enterprise Survey is useful for both policymakers and researchers. The surveys are repeated over time to track changes and benchmark the effects of reforms on firms' performance.

http://www.enterprisesurveys.org

enterprisesurveys@worldbank.org

LIST OF INDICATORS

Introduction to ES Indicators, By Subgroup 14
Indicator Comparability 15
Computing Averages or Medians 15
Computing Regional and Income Group Averages 15
Handling of Outliers 15

Definitions of Subgroup 16

Regulations 17

[reg1] Average senior management time spent dealing with the requirements of government regulation (%) 18
[bus2] Average days to obtain an operating license 19
[bus3] [B-READY] Days to obtain a construction-related permit 20
[bus1] Average days to obtain an import license 21
[reg13] Average duration composite index to obtain five services 22
[reg9] [B-READY] Average days to receive payment under government contract 24
[reg10] [B-READY] Percent of firms visited or inspected for health or safety 25
[reg11] [B-READY] Percent of firms with a report issued for health or safety inspection 26
[bus5] Percent of firms identifying business licensing and permits as a major or very severe constraint 27
[reg8] Percent of firms identifying access to land as a major or very severe constraint 28
[reg12] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of access to land as a constraint 29
[reg7] Percent of firms identifying political instability as a major or very severe constraint 30

Taxes 31

[reg6] Percent of firms visited or required to meet with tax officials 32
[reg2] Average number of visits or required meetings with tax officials 33
[reg2_c] If there were visits, Average number of visits or required meetings with tax officials 34
[tax1] [B-READY] Hours spent on tax compliance annually [median] 35
[tax2] [B-READY] Percent of firms filing taxes electronically 36
[tax3] [B-READY] Percent of firms paying taxes electronically 37
[tax4] [B-READY] Weeks until the final tax audit report [median] 38
[tax5] [B-READY] Weeks to receive VAT refund [median] 39
[tax6] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting too long or complicated refund process as the main reason for not applying for a VAT refund, among those eligible for one 40

[tax7] [B-READY] Average reported share of social security and employment-based taxes in annual cost of labor 41
[tax8] [B-READY] Average reported effective income-based tax rate 42
[reg4] Percent of firms identifying tax rates as a major or very severe constraint 43
[reg5] Percent of firms identifying tax administration as a major or very severe constraint 44
Finance 45
[fin23] Percent of firms that are fully credit constrained 46
[fin24] Percent of firms that are partially credit constrained 48
[fin34] Percent of firms that are partially or fully credit constrained 51
[fin25] Percent of firms that are credit unconstrained 53
[fin15] Percent of firms with a checking or savings account 55
[fin14] Percent of firms with a bank loan/line of credit 56
[fin11] Average proportion of loans requiring collateral (%) 57
[fin10] Average value of collateral needed for a loan (% of the loan amount) 58
[fin26] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting unfavorable rates, collateral, or procedures as main reason for not applying for loans 59
[fin20] Percent of firms not needing a loan 60
[fin27] [B-READY] Average days to receive a decision on loan application 61
[fin21] Percent of firms whose recent loan application was rejected 62
[fin12] Percent of firms using banks to finance investments 63
[fin1] Average proportion of investment financed internally (%) 64
[fin2] Average proportion of investment financed by banks (%) 65
[fin3] Average proportion of investment financed by supplier/customer credit (%) 66
[fin4] Average proportion of investment financed by equity or stock sales (%) 67
[fin5] Average proportion of investment financed by other financing (%) 68
[fin13] Percent of firms using banks to finance working capital 69
[fin22] Percent of firms using supplier/customer credit to finance working capital 70
[fin6] Average proportion of working capital financed internally (%) 71
[fin7] Average proportion of working capital financed by banks (%) 72
[fin8] Average proportion of working capital financed by supplier/customer credit (%) 73
[fin9] Average proportion of working capital financed by other financing (%) 74
[fin19] Average proportion of working capital financed externally (%) 75
[t2] Percent of firms with an annual financial statement reviewed by external auditors 76
[fin28] [B-READY] Average proportion of sales paid by customers electronically 77

[fin29] [B-READY] Average days to receive the main type of electronic payment 78
[fin30] [B-READY] Average cost to receive main type of electronic payment (% of transaction) 79
[fin31] [B-READY] Average proportion of payments made electronically 80
[fin32] [B-READY] Average cost to make main type of electronic payment (% of transaction) 81
[fin16] Percent of firms identifying access to finance as a major or very severe constraint 82
[fin33] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of access to finance as a constraint 83
[fin17] Average proportion of sales that are pre-paid (%) 84
[fin18] Average proportion of sales sold on credit (%) 85

Infrastructure and Climate 86

[in16] Percent of firms experiencing electrical outages 87
[in2] [B-READY] Average number of electrical outages in a typical month 88
[in3] [B-READY] Duration, in hours, of a typical electrical outage [median] 89
[in3_c] If there were outages, average duration in hours of a typical electrical outage 90
[in15] Average total time of power outages per month 91
[in4] [B-READY] Losses due to electrical outages (% of annual sales) [median] 92
[in4_c] If there were outages, average losses due to electrical outages (% of annual sales) 93
[in9] [B-READY] Percent of firms owning or sharing a generator 94
[in10] Average proportion of electricity from a generator (%) 95
[in10_c] If a generator is used, average proportion of electricity from a generator (%) 96
[in1] [B-READY] Days to obtain an electrical connection, upon application 97
[in12] Percent of firms identifying electricity as a major or very severe constraint 98
[in17] Percent of firms experiencing water insufficiencies* 99
[in18] [B-READY] Percent of firms experiencing water insufficiencies 100
[in6] Average number of water insufficiencies in a typical month* 101
[in19] Average number of water insufficiencies in a typical month 102
[in20] Average duration, in hours, of a typical water shortage 103
[in7] Average duration, in hours, of insufficient water supplies* 104
[in7_c] If there were shortages, Average Duration in hours of the Water Shortage* 105
[in5] [B-READY] Days to obtain a water connection 106
[in21] [B-READY] Percent of firms experiencing internet disruptions 107
[in22] [B-READY] Days to obtain internet connection [median] 108
[in14] Average proportion of products lost to breakage or spoilage during shipping to domestic markets (%)* 109
[in11] Percent of firms identifying transportation as a major or very severe constraint 110

[in23] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of transportation as a constraint....111
[in24] Percent of firms experiencing damage of physical assets due to extreme weather....112
[in25] Percent of firms monitoring own CO2 emissions over last 3 years....113
[in26] Percent of firms adopting energy management measures to reduce emissions over last 3 years....114
Gender....115
[gend1] Percent of firms with women participation in ownership....116
[gend6] Percent of firms with majority women ownership....117
[gend4] Percent of firms with a woman top manager....118
[gend7] [B-READY] Percent of firms owned or managed by women among those that held a government contract in last 3 years....119
[gend2] Average proportion of permanent full-time workers that are women (%)....120
[gend5] Average proportion of permanent full-time production workers that are women (%)*....121
[gend3] Average proportion of permanent full-time non-production workers that are women (%)*....122
[gend8] Average proportion of women workers offered formal training over last fiscal year (%)*....123
[gend9] Average proportion of women workers offered formal training over last fiscal year (%, only service sector)....124
Trade....125
[tr10] Percent of firms exporting directly or indirectly at least 1% of sales....126
[tr15] Percent of firms exporting directly at least 1% of sales....127
[tr17] Percent of firms exporting directly or indirectly at least 10% of sales....128
[tr16] Percent of firms exporting directly at least 10% of sales....129
[tr5] Average proportion of total sales that are exported directly (%)....130
[tr6] Average proportion of total sales that are exported indirectly (%)....131
[tr4] Average proportion of total sales that are domestic sales (%)....132
[tr1] Average days to clear direct exports through customs*....133
[tr18] Days for exported goods to clear all border control agencies [median]....134
[tr18_u] [B-READY] Average days for all exported goods to clear all border control agencies....135
[tr19] [B-READY] Percent of firms that export at least some products via parcel service....136
[tr20] [B-READY] Average of typical costs to comply with all export requirements (% of value of goods exported)....137
[tr12] Average value of products exported directly lost due to theft (%)....138
[tr13] Average value of products exported directly lost due to breakage or spoilage (%)....139
[tr11] Percent of firms using material inputs and/or supplies of foreign origin*....140
[tr21] Percent of firms using material inputs and/or supplies of foreign origin....141

[tr8] Average proportion of total inputs that are of foreign origin (%)* 142
[tr22] Average proportion of total inputs that are of foreign origin (%) 143
[tr7] Average proportion of total inputs that are of domestic origin (%)* 144
[tr2] Average days to clear imports from customs* 145
[tr23] Average days to clear imports from customs 146
[tr24] Days for imported goods to clear all border control agencies [median] 147
[tr24_u] [B-READY] Average days for all imported goods to clear all border control agencies 148
[tr25] [B-READY] Average of typical costs to comply with all import requirements (% of value of goods imported) 149
[tr9] Percent of firms identifying customs and trade regulations as a major or very severe constraint 150
[tr26] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of customs and trade regulations as a constraint 151

Competition and Public Procurement 152

[comp1] [B-READY] Average index of market share of the largest competitor (excluding firms whose main market is international) 153
[comp2] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting less than two competitors in their main product's main market (excluding firms whose main market is international) 154
[comp3] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting between two and five (inclusive) competitors in their main product's main market (excluding firms whose main market is international) 155
[comp4] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting more than five competitors in their main product's main market (excluding firms whose main market is international) 156
[comp5] [B-READY] Percent of firms that cannot increase prices more than competitors without losing customers 157
[comp6] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting that their prices are regulated 158
[comp7] [B-READY] Average index of change of level of competition over last year 159
[comp8] [B-READY] Average index of difficulty to switch internet providers 160
[comp9] [B-READY] Average perceptions of the degree of difficulty to comply with government contract tender requirements 161

Corruption 162

[graft3] Bribery incidence (percent of firms experiencing at least one bribe payment request) 163
[graft2] Average bribery depth (% of public transactions where a gift or informal payment was requested) 165
[graft1] Average graft index 167
[corr1] Percent of firms expected to give gifts in meetings with tax officials 169
[corr2] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to secure government contract 170
[corr3] Average value of gift expected to secure a government contract (% of contract value) 171

[corr10] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get an operating license....172
[corr9] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get an import license....173
[corr8] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get a construction permit....174
[corr6] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get an electrical connection....175
[corr7] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get a water connection....176
[corr4] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to public officials "to get things done"....177
[corr11] Percent of firms identifying corruption as a major or very severe constraint....178

Informality....179

[infor1] Percent of firms competing against unregistered or informal firms....180
[infor4] Percent of firms formally registered when they started operations....181
[infor5] Average number of years firm operated without formal registration....182
[infor2] Percent of firms identifying practices of competitors in the informal sector as a major or very severe constraint....183

Dispute Resolution....184

[disp1] Percent of firms that had any commercial dispute....185
[disp2] Percent of firms that use courts, arbitration, mediation, or conciliation to resolve or attempt to resolve its commercial disputes....186
[disp3] [B-READY] Average perceptions of courts being independent and impartial in resolving commercial disputes....187
[disp4] [B-READY] Average perceptions of arbitration being a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes....188
[disp5] [B-READY] Average perceptions of mediation being a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes....189
[crime9] Percent of firms identifying the courts as a major or very severe constraint....190
[disp6] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of courts as a constraint....191
[corr12] Percent of firms believing the court system is fair, impartial and uncorrupted....192

Jobs....193

[jobs1] Jobs share....194
[jobs2] Firms that added jobs....195
[jobs3] Job expansion....196
[jobs4] Share in job expansion....197
[jobs5] Firms that reduced jobs....198
[jobs6] Job contraction....199

[jobs7] Share in job contraction 200
[jobs8] Net job creation 201
[jobs9] Share in net job creation 202

Workforce 203

[wk1] [B-READY] Percent of firms offering formal training over last fiscal year 204
[wk2] Average proportion of workers offered formal training over last fiscal year (%)* 205
[wk8] Average years of the top manager's experience working in the firm's sector 206
[wk20] Percent of firms where the largest owner is also the top manager 207
[wk14] Average number of workers 208
[wk21] Average number of permanent full-time equivalent workers 209
[wk11] Average number of temporary workers 211
[wk12] Average number of permanent full-time workers 212
[wk3] Average number of permanent skilled production workers* 213
[wk4] Average number of permanent unskilled production workers* 214
[wk6] Average number of permanent production workers* 215
[wk7] Average number of permanent non-production workers* 216
[wk18] Average proportion of permanent workers, out of all workers 217
[wk22] Average proportion of permanent workers, out of all permanent full-time equivalent workers 218
[wk17] Average proportion of temporary workers out of all workers 220
[wk15] Average proportion of production workers, out of all permanent workers* 221
[wk16] Average proportion of non-production workers out of all permanent workers* 222
[wk19] Average proportion of skilled workers, out of all permanent production workers (%)* 223
[wk23] Average proportion of permanent full time workers that completed high school 224
[wk13] Average proportion of unskilled workers out of all permanent production workers (%)* 225
[wk24] [B-READY] Average weeks to dismiss a full-time permanent worker 226
[wk25] [B-READY] Average weeks paid in severance 227
[wk26] [B-READY] Percent of firms involved in labor dispute over last 3 years 228
[wk27] [B-READY] Average months to resolve labor dispute 229
[wk9] Percent of firms identifying labor regulations as a major or very severe constraint 230
[wk28] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of labor regulations as a constraint 231
[wk10] Percent of firms identifying an inadequately educated workforce as a major or very severe constraint 232

Management Practices 233

[mgmt1] Average management practices index for medium and large firms 234

[mgmt2] Average score of medium and large firms on action when a problem arose....235
[mgmt3] Average score of medium and large firms on number of performance indicators monitored....236
[mgmt4] Average score of medium and large firms on time focus of production/service provision targets....237
[mgmt5] Average score of medium and large firms on achievability of production/service provision targets....238
[mgmt6] Average score of medium and large firms on knowledge of production/service provision targets....239
[mgmt7] Average score of medium and large firms on basis of managers' performance bonuses....240
[mgmt8] Average score of medium and large firms on extent to which non-managers are promoted based on performance....241
[mgmt9] Average score of medium and large firms on extent to which under-performing non-managers are reassigned or dismissed....242
Innovation and Technology....243
[t7] Percent of firms that introduced a new product/service over last 3 years....244
[t7_ml] [B-READY] Percent of medium and large firms that introduced a new product/service over last 3 years....245
[t8] Percent of firms whose new product/service is also new to the main market....246
[t9] Percent of firms that introduced a process innovation over last 3 years....247
[t9_ml] [B-READY] Percent of medium and large firms that introduced a process innovation over last 3 years....248
[t10] [B-READY] Percent of medium and large firms that spend on R&D in the last fiscal years....249
[t11] Percent of medium and large firms that introduced a new product/service and process over last 3 years, and spent on R&D over last fiscal year....250
[t1] [B-READY] Percent of firms with an internationally-recognized quality certification....251
[t4] Percent of firms using technology licensed from foreign companies*....252
[t5] Percent of firms having their own web site....253
Firm Profile....254
[perf1] Average real annual sales growth (%)....255
[perf2] Average annual employment growth (%)....256
[perf3] Average real annual labor productivity growth (%)....257
[perf4] Percent of firms buying fixed assets....259
[t3] Average capacity utilization (%)*....260
[car1] Average age of the establishment (years)....261
[car7] Percent of firms with at least 10% of foreign ownership....262
[car8] Percent of firms with at least 10% of government/state ownership....263

[car2] Average proportion of private domestic ownership in a firm (%) 264
[car3] Average proportion of private foreign ownership in a firm (%) 265
[car4] Average proportion of government/state ownership in a firm (%) 266
[car5] Average proportion of other ownership in a firm (%) 267
[car6] Average proportion of a firm held by the largest owner(s) (%) 268
[lform3] Percent of firms with legal status of Sole Proprietorship 269
[lform] Legal status 270
[lform_max] Most common legal form 271
[lform1] Percent of firms with legal status of publicly listed company 272
[lform2] Percent of firms with legal status of shareholding company with non-traded or privately traded shares 273
[lform4] Percent of firms with legal status of Partnership 274
[lform5] Percent of firms with legal status of Limited Partnership 275
[lform6] Legal status - Other 276

Biggest Obstacle 277

[obst1] Percent of firms choosing access to finance as their biggest obstacle 278
[obst2] Percent of firms choosing access to land as their biggest obstacle 279
[obst3] Percent of firms choosing business licensing and permits as their biggest obstacle 280
[obst4] Percent of firms choosing corruption as their biggest obstacle 281
[obst5] Percent of firms choosing courts as their biggest obstacle 282
[obst6] Percent of firms choosing crime, theft and disorder as their biggest obstacle 283
[obst7] Percent of firms choosing customs and trade regulations as their biggest obstacle 284
[obst8] Percent of firms choosing electricity as their biggest obstacle 285
[obst9] Percent of firms choosing inadequately educated workforce as their biggest obstacle 286
[obst10] Percent of firms choosing labor regulations as their biggest obstacle 287
[obst11] Percent of firms choosing political instability as their biggest obstacle 288
[obst12] Percent of firms choosing practices of the informal sector as their biggest obstacle 289
[obst13] Percent of firms choosing tax administration as their biggest obstacle 290
[obst14] Percent of firms choosing tax rates as their biggest obstacle 291
[obst15] Percent of firms choosing transportation as their biggest obstacle 292

CRIME 293

[crime1] Percent of firms paying for security 294
[crime10] Percent of firms experiencing losses due to theft and vandalism 295
[crime3] Average losses due to theft and vandalism against the firm (% of annual sales) 296

[crime3_c] If there were losses, average losses due to theft and vandalism (% of annual sales) 297
[crime2] Average security costs (% of annual sales) 298
[crime2_c] If the establishment pays for security, average security costs (% of annual sales) 299
[crime5] Average value of products shipped to supply domestic markets that were lost due to theft (% of product value)* 300
[crime8] Percent of firms identifying crime, theft and disorder as a major or very severe constraint 301
Descriptions of Indicator Updates 302
Appendix 306

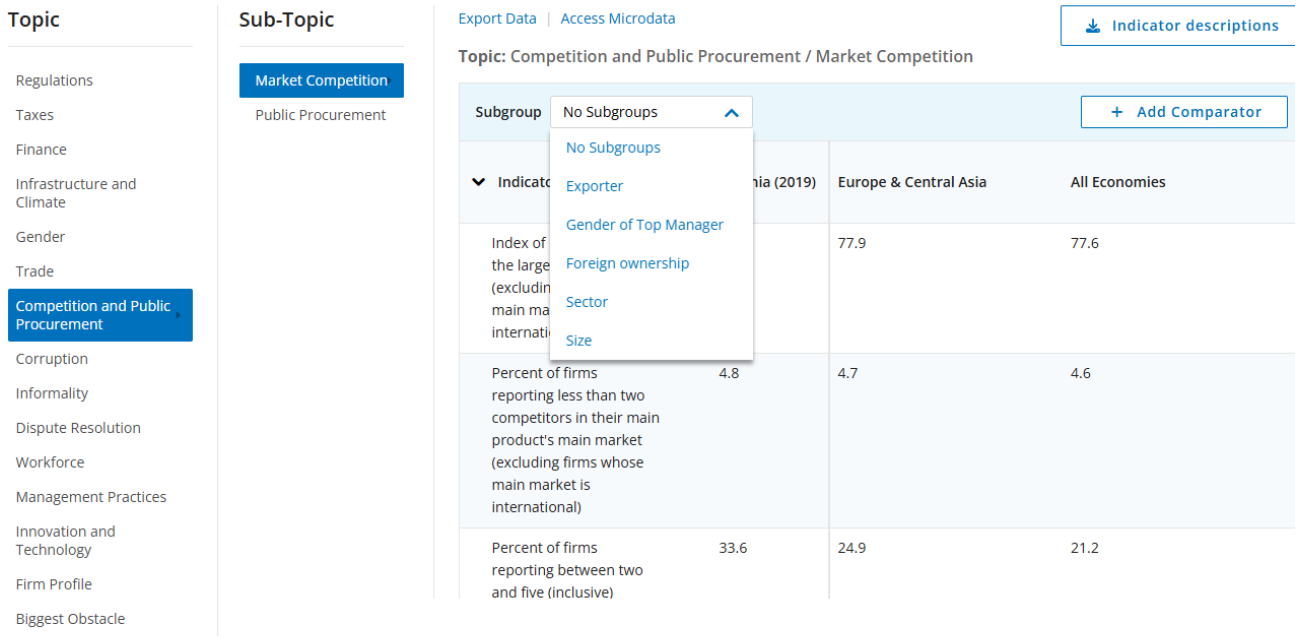
Abbreviations	
BEEPS	Enterprise Surveys implemented in Eastern Europe and Central Asian countries are also known as Business Environment and Enterprise Performance Surveys (BEEPS) and are jointly conducted by the World Bank and the European Bank for Reconstruction and Development.
ECA	European and Central Asia region
LAC	Latin America and the Caribbean region
EAP	East Asia and Pacific region
SAR	South Asia region
AFR	Sub-Saharan Africa region
MENA	Middle East and North Africa region
NA	North America

Notes	
*	This indicator is computed using data from manufacturing firms only.

INTRODUCTION TO ES INDICATORS, BY SUBGROUP

In addition to country-level statistics, Enterprise Survey (ES) indicators are presented by subgroups based on firm characteristics. Indicators from surveys following the **Global** sampling methodology are representative at the country level. However, more care is necessary when interpreting indicators by subgroups.

In the figure below, the drop-down menu on each country page allows the user to select how they wish to view an indicator. The user can view indicator values for the entire sample or by subgroups. Surveys following the **Global** methodology are stratified by business sector, location, and firm size. When analyzing ES indicators in these groupings, the results are representative of the associated populations[1]. However, since the **Global** sampling methodology does not stratify by gender of the top manager, exporter status, or ownership (ex post groupings), the intended level of precision is not guaranteed for indicator values by these groupings.



* For indicator definitions, please see "Indicator descriptions" in the top right corner of the table.

Surveys that are Non-Global do not yield results that are representative of the firm population in a country. Please check if a survey is Global or not, as this will greatly affect the interpretation of survey results.

INDICATOR COMPARABILITY

Indicators are comparable across all the countries and years in surveys that followed the Enterprise Surveys Global Methodology. Some older surveys did not follow the Global methodology, and are not comparable to other surveys. Please refer to the Datasets file for a list of Global and Non-Global surveys.

COMPUTING AVERAGES OR MEDIANS

Averages and medians—whether at the national or sub-national level, or across cuts such as sector and firm size—are calculated using sampling weights to ensure that the resulting indicators reflect the underlying business population. For more information on sampling weights, please refer to the WBES Sampling Note.

Averages and medians require more than five observations to be computed; average growth rates require at least 30. If the number of observations falls below the relevant threshold, the corresponding indicator is not calculated and is reported as n.a. ("not applicable") on the website and in all relevant materials.

COMPUTING REGIONAL AND INCOME GROUP AVERAGES

Regional and income group averages of indicators are computed by taking a simple average of country-level estimates. For each economy, only the latest available year of survey data is used in this computation. Only surveys posted during the years 2010-2017, and adhering to the Enterprise Surveys Global Methodology, are used to compute these regional and "all countries" averages.

In June 2017, an inconsistency was found and fixed in the computation of regional and income averages found in the Country Highlights and Country Profiles.

HANDLING OF OUTLIERS

For indicators that use questions with potentially unbounded responses, extreme values are identified and turned into missing as follows. The variables are first log-transformed as $Ln(x+1)$, to add symmetry to the distribution, while including zeros. The observations that fall outside the three standard deviations away from the sample mean of the log-transformed variable at the survey-level are treated as extreme and removed from the calculations of the corresponding indicators (i.e., they are turned into missing).

Definitions of Subgroup

Table 1. Definition of Subgroups

Subgroup	Subgroup levels	Description
Note: The cuts below are included in the levels of sampling stratification. The sufficient sample sizes should ensure the intended level of precision for the indicator values analyzed at these levels. Please refer to the Sampling Note on the Methodology page of the website.		
Firm Size	Small: 5-19 workers Medium: 20-99 workers Large: 100+ Very large: varies by very large economy (top 1% of the size distribution for the population)	Firm size is a composite measure of permanent and temporary workers. The number of temporary workers is adjusted by the average number of months worked in a year.
Location	Varies by Survey	Enterprise Surveys covers selected regions within a country that represent the largest centers of production and business enterprise.
Business Sector	Varies by Survey	Surveys are stratified by business sector. At a minimum, the stratification delineates between Manufacturing and Services firms. In larger economies, additional sectors are selected for stratification.
Note: The cuts below are NOT included in the levels of stratification. The resulting sample sizes are not guaranteed to ensure the intended level of precision for the indicator values analyzed at these levels.		
Gender of Top Manager	Male Female	Respondents are asked to report the gender of the top manager. This variable is only available in the latest surveys using the **Global** methodology.
Exporting Status	Non-exporter Exporter	A firm is an exporter if at least 10 percent of its annual sales is derived from direct exports
Ownership (Domestic vs. Foreign)	Domestic (less than 10% foreign ownership) At least 10% Foreign Ownership	A firm is considered to have foreign ownership if at least 10 percent of ownership is held by foreigners.

REGULATIONS

Good economic governance in areas of regulations, permits and licenses are among the fundamental pillars for the creation of a favorable business environment.

The Enterprise Surveys provide qualitative and quantitative measures of regulations. For example, the Enterprise Surveys approximates the "time tax" imposed by regulations: it measures the time spent by senior management in meetings with public officials, it measures the number of days to obtain an operating license, construction-related permit and an import license, to name a few.

Effective regulations address market failures that inhibit productive investment and reconcile private and public interests. The number of permits and approvals that businesses need to obtain, and the time it takes to obtain them, are expensive and time consuming. The existing legislation of a country also determines the mix of legal forms private firms take and determines the level of protection for investors thus affecting the incentives to invest. Those indicators focus on the efficiency of business licensing and permit services. The indicators evaluate the delays faced when demanding these services.

Regulations

[reg1] Average senior management time spent dealing with the requirements of government regulation (%)

Description

Average percentage of senior management's time that is spent in a typical week dealing with requirements imposed by government regulations (eg. Taxes, customs, labor regulations, licensing and registration), including dealings with officials, completing forms, et cetera.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.2**.**

J.2	In a typical week over the last year, what percentage of total senior management's time was spent on dealing with requirements imposed by government regulations? [By senior management I mean managers, directors, and officers above direct supervisors of production or sales workers. Some examples of government regulations are taxes, customs, labor regulations, licensing and registration, including dealings with officials and completing forms]

	Percent
Senior management's time spent on dealing with regulations	**j2** %
No time was spent	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable j2.
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

REGULATIONS

[bus2] Average days to obtain an operating license

Description

The average wait, in days, to obtain an operating license.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.14.

J.14	Approximately how many days did it take to obtain this operating license from the day of the application to the day it was granted?

	Days
Wait for operating license	**j14**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable j14
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable j14

Back to List of Indicators

REGULATIONS

[bus3] [B-READY] Days to obtain a construction-related permit

Description

There are two indicators measuring the duration to obtain a construction-related permit: the average number of days required to obtain a construction permit (bus3), and the median number of days required to obtain a construction permit (bready_bus3_median). B-READY report uses the latter.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable G.3.

G.3	In reference to that application for a construction-related permit, approximately how many days did it take to obtain it from the day of the application to the day the permit was granted?

	Days
Wait for a construction-related permit	**g3**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable g3
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable g3

Back to List of Indicators

REGULATIONS

[bus1] Average days to obtain an import license

Description

Average wait, in days, to obtain import license.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.11.

J.11	Approximately how many days did it take to obtain this import license from the day of the application to the day it was granted?

	Days
Wait for import license	**j11**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable j11
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable j11

Back to List of Indicators

REGULATIONS

[reg13] Average duration composite index to obtain five services

Description

The duration composite index measures average duration (in days, for each firm) required to obtain five key services: an import license, an operating license, a construction-related permit, an electrical connection, and a water connection.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This duration composite index is created from the following variables: J11**,** J14, G3, C4 and C14

J.11	Approximately how many days did it take to obtain this import license from the day of the application to the day it was granted?

	Days
Wait for import license	**j11**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

J.14	Approximately how many days did it take to obtain this operating license from the day of the application to the day it was granted?

	Days
Wait for operating license	**j14**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

G.3	In reference to that application for a construction-related permit, approximately how many days did it take to obtain it from the day of the application to the day the permit was granted?

	Days
Wait for a construction-related permit	**g3**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

C.4	In reference to that application for an electrical connection, approximately how many days did it take to obtain it from the day of the application to the day the service was received?

	Days
Wait for electrical connection	c4
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

C.13	In reference to that application for a water connection, approximately how many days did it take to obtain it from the day of the application to the day the service was received?

	Days
Wait for water connection	c13
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 4, 2026	First released

Back to List of Indicators

Regulations

[reg9] [B-READY] Average days to receive payment under government contract

Description

Number of days to receive payment under government contract after the firm has delivered an invoice to the relevant authority.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.43.

J.43	Approximately, how many days does it take for this establishment to receive payment under a government contract after it has delivered an invoice to the relevant authority? If this establishment has received multiple payments or contracts, please provide the time of the largest payment.

	Days
Wait for payment	**j43**
ONE DAY OR LESS	**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

Regulations

[reg10] [B-READY] Percent of firms visited or inspected for health or safety

Description

Percentage of firms visited or inspected by a government labor inspector or required to meet with one, in reference to workplace health and safety.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.40.

L.40	During fiscal year **[insert the last fiscal year],** in reference to workplace health and safety, was this establishment visited or inspected by a government labor inspector or has it been required to meet with one?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO L.30***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO L.30***
		l40

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

Regulations

[reg11] [B-READY] Percent of firms with a report issued for health or safety inspection

Description

Percentage of firms with a report issued for health or safety inspection.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.41.

L.41	As a result of these inspections, was a report issued to the establishment by the inspectorate? If there has been more than one inspection, please consider the latest **completed** inspection.

Yes	1
No	2
NO INSPECTION HAS BEEN CONCLUDED	**-5**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

l41

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

REGULATIONS

[bus5] Percent of firms identifying business licensing and permits as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying business licensing and permits as "major" or "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.30c.

J.30	As I list some factors that can affect the current operations of a business, please look at this card and tell me the degree to which you think each factor is an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment. **SHOW CARD 21**

ROTATE OPTIONS	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Business licensing and permits **j30c**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

REGULATIONS

[reg8] Percent of firms identifying access to land as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying access to land as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: g30a==3 or 4 is coded as 100; g30a ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable g30a.

G.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **Access to Land** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment?

							(SPONTANEOUS)	
		No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	DON'T KNOW	DOES NOT APPLY
Access to land	g30a	0	1	2	3	4	-9	-7

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

Regulations

[reg12] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of access to land as a constraint

Description

Perceptions index of access to land as a constraint on a scale of 0 to 100. For this indicator, 0 is assigned for “no obstacle”, 25 for “minor” obstacle, 50 for “moderate” obstacle, 75 for “major” obstacle, and 100 for “very severe” obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable G.30a.

G.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **access to land** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment?

						(SPONTANEOUS)	
	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	DON’T KNOW	DOES NOT APPLY
Access to land **g30a**	0	1	2	3	4	-9	-7

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

REGULATIONS

[reg7] Percent of firms identifying political instability as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying political instability as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: j30e==3 or 4 is coded as 100; j30e ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable j30e.

J.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is/are **[INSERT OPTION]** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 24**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Political instability **j30e**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

Taxes play a crucial role in private sector development by providing the necessary public funds to build infrastructure, maintain social services, and create a stable economic environment. Effective tax administration reduces evasion, ensures fairness, and fosters a conducive business climate, thereby encouraging investment and growth in the private sector.

The Enterprise Surveys provide quantitative and qualitative measures of taxation and its administration. For example, the Enterprise Surveys collects information about the average number of visits or required meetings with tax officials, and the average number of tax inspections or meetings with tax inspectors in the last year. Furthermore, the Enterprise Surveys provides information about firms' perception about the taxes and their administration in their respective economy.

TAXES

[reg6] Percent of firms visited or required to meet with tax officials

Description

Percentage of firms that were visited or inspected by tax officials or were required to meet with them over the last year.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.3.

J.3	Over the last year, was this establishment visited or inspected by tax officials or required to meet with them?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

j3

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[reg2] Average number of visits or required meetings with tax officials

Description

Average number of visits or required meetings with tax officials. If the respondent answered "No" to question J.3, a zero is recorded for the average number of visits.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables J.3 and J.4.

J.3	Over the last year, was this establishment visited or inspected by tax officials?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION J.6a***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION J.6a***
		j3

J.4	Over the last year, how many times was this establishment either inspected by tax officials or required to meet with them?

	Number
Times inspected or met with tax officials	**j4**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable j4
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable j4
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[reg2_c] If there were visits, Average number of visits or required meetings with tax officials

Description

If there were a positive number of visits or required meetings with tax officials, what was the average number? The variable J.4 only allows a positive number of visits as a response.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.4.

J.4	Over the last year, how many times was this establishment either inspected by tax officials or required to meet with them?

	Number
Times inspected or met with tax officials	**j4**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

November 10, 2009	Conditional Indicator Created
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable j4
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax1] [B-READY] Hours spent on tax compliance annually [median]

Description

The total annual number of hours required for the preparation, filing, and payment of all taxes (profit taxes, labor taxes, VAT, GST, or sales taxes) for this establishment in fiscal year.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.35a.

J.35a	Over fiscal year **[a20y]**, what was the total number of hours required for the preparation, filing, and payment of all taxes (profit taxes, labor taxes, **[consumptiontax]**, or sales taxes) for this establishment?

	Hours
Total hours to prepare, file, and pay taxes	**j35a**
ONE HOUR OR LESS	**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax2] [B-READY] Percent of firms filing taxes electronically

Description

Percentage of firms filing taxes electronically either fully or partially.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.36.

J.36	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment **file** its taxes electronically? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS**

Yes, fully	1
Yes, partially	2
No	3
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

j36

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax3] [B-READY] Percent of firms paying taxes electronically

Description

Percentage of firms paying taxes electronically either fully or partially.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.37.

J.37	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment **pay** its taxes electronically? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS**

Yes, fully	1
Yes, partially	2
No	3
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

j37

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax4] [B-READY] Weeks until the final tax audit report [median]

Description

Number of weeks between the first interaction with the auditors and when the final audit report was received.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.33.

J.33	How many weeks did it take between the first interaction with the auditors and when the final audit report was received?

	Weeks
Duration of audit in weeks	j33
ONE WEEK OR LESS	1
AUDIT IS ONGOING	-5
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax5] [B-READY] Weeks to receive VAT refund [median]

Description

Median number of weeks from the establishment submitted its application until the VAT refund was received.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.39 only when VAT is used in an economy (vat_applicable==1).

If vat_applicable==1

J.39	In reference to the most recent VAT refund, how many weeks did it take from when the establishment submitted its application until the refund was received?

	Weeks	
Weeks to receive VAT refund	j39	*GO TO J.6a*
ONE WEEK OR LESS	1	*GO TO J.6a*
REFUND STILL OUTSTANDING	-5	*GO TO J.6a*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	*GO TO J.6a*

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax6] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting too long or complicated refund process as the main reason for not applying for a VAT refund, among those eligible for one

Description

Percentage of firms reporting too long or complicated refund process as the main reason for not applying for a VAT refund, among those providing a reason other than no need.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.40.

If vat_applicable==1

J.40	What was the main reason this establishment did not apply for a VAT refund?

VAT refunds take too long to receive	1
The application for a VAT refund is too complicated	2
The establishment did not need to apply for a VAT refund	3
Other	4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

j40

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax7] [B-READY] Average reported share of social security and employment-based taxes in annual cost of labor

Description

The share of annual labor costs attributed to of social security payments and employment-based taxes (excluding employee taxes that were withheld)

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable N.2a and N.2a2.

N.2	From this establishment's Income Statement for fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** please provide the following in **[LCUs]:** **SHOW CARD 30**

INTERVIEWER: READ OUT	**[Insert LCUs]**	**(SPONTANEOUS)**	
		DON'T KNOW	**DOES NOT APPLY**
Total annual cost of labor including wages, salaries, bonuses, social security payments	**n2a**	**-9**	
Of which total annual costs of social security payments and employment-based taxes, excluding employee taxes that were withheld	**n2a2**	**-9**	

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[tax8] [B-READY] Average reported effective income-based tax rate

Description

As a share of total annual gross profits, the cost of annual income-based taxes actually paid.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable N.11.

N.11	For fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]** as a share of total annual gross profits, what was the cost of annual income-based taxes? Please exclude any tax credits or deductions. (If taxes have not yet been paid, please include the expected tax payments.)

	Percent	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	REFUSAL (SPONTANEOUS)
Effective rate of income-based taxes	**n11** %	**-9**	**-8**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[reg4] Percent of firms identifying tax rates as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying tax rates as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: j30a==3 or 4 is coded as 100; j30a ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.30a.

J.30	As I list some factors that can affect the current operations of a business, please look at this card and tell me the degree to which you think each factor is an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment. **SHOW CARD 21**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Tax rates **j30a**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TAXES

[reg5] Percent of firms identifying tax administration as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying tax administration as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: j30b==3 or 4 is coded as 100; j30b ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.30b.

J.30	As I list some factors that can affect the current operations of a business, please look at this card and tell me the degree to which you think each factor is an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment. **SHOW CARD 21**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Tax administration **j30b**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

The Enterprise Surveys provide indicators of how firms finance their operations and of the characteristics of their financial transactions. For example, Enterprise Surveys provide indicators that compare the relative use of various sources to finance investment. Excessive reliance on internal funds is a sign of potentially inefficient financial intermediation. Another set of indicators measures the use of financial markets by individual firms. It presents the percentage of working capital that is financed by external sources to the firm, and a measure of the burden imposed by loan requirements measured by collateral levels relative to the value of the loans. Additional indicators focus on the use of financial services by private firms both on the credit side, by measuring the percentage of firms with bank loans or lines or credit, and on the deposit mobilization side, by measuring the percentage of firms with checking or savings accounts.

[fin23] Percent of firms that are fully credit constrained

Description

Indicator fin23 (along with fin24 and fin25) is based on Islam and Rodriguez Meza (2023, Islam, Asif Mohammed and Jorge Luis Rodriguez Meza. "How Prevalent Are Credit-Constrained Firms in the Formal Private Sector? Evidence Using Global Surveys". World Bank Policy Research Working Paper; no. WPS 10502). Firms are categorized into fully credit constrained, partially credit constrained, or credit unconstrained as illustrated in the appendix figure. Four sets of survey questions are used for the categorization: (i) whether the firm applied for a loan or line of credit (k16); (ii) if so, what was the outcome of this application (k17); (iii) if it did not apply, the reason for not applying (k20a1); and (iv) whether the firm has access to external finance (variables k3 and k5).

Firms are categorized as fully credit constrained if they do not have access to external finance, and any of the following two conditions are met: (1) the firm did not apply for a loan for any reason other than the lack of need for it; or (2) the firm applied for a loan but the application was rejected, even when it has access to equity financing.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables: K.3a, K.5a, K3bc, K3e, K3f, K3hd, K5bc, K5e, K5f, K5hdj, K.5i, K.16, K.17, K.20a1.

K.3	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital, that is the funds available for day-to-day operations, that were financed from each of the following sources? **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Internal funds or retained earnings	**k3a** %	**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	**k3bc** %	**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions, which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	**k3e** %	**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	**k3f** %	**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.	**k3hd** %	**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW

K.5	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion or **[Insert LCU]** amount of this establishment's total purchases of fixed assets that were financed from the following sources: **SHOW CARD 18**

	Percent	**OR**	**Amount [Insert LCUs]**	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Internal funds or retained earnings	**k5a**%		**k5a1**	**-9**
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares	**k5i** %		**k5i1**	**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	**k5bc**%		**k5bc1**	**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions, which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	**k5e** %		**k5e1**	**-9**

Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	k5f %		k5f1	-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc.	k5hdj%		k5hdj1	-9
	100%		n5a+n5b	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100% OR THAT TOTAL SUM EQUALS TOTAL PURCHASES IN N5 UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW

K.16	Referring again to the last fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment apply for any loans or lines of credit?

Yes	1	*GO TO QUESTION K.20*
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	*GO TO QUESTION K.21*
		k16

K.17	What was the **main** reason why this establishment did not apply for any line of credit or loan? **SHOW CARD 18**

No need for a loan – establishment had sufficient capital	1
Application procedures were complex	2
Interest rates were not favorable	3
Collateral requirements were too high	4
Size of loan and maturity were insufficient	5
Did not think it would be approved	6
Other	7
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
	k17

K.20	Referring only to this most recent application for a line of credit or loan, what was the outcome of that application?

Application was approved in full	1	
Application was approved in part	2	
Application was rejected	3	
Application was withdrawn	4	
APPLICATION STILL IN PROCESS	**-6**	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		k20a1

Notes	
Indicator Updates	
June 26, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[fin24] Percent of firms that are partially credit constrained

Description

Indicator fin24 (along with fin23 and fin25) is based on Islam and Rodriguez Meza (2023, Islam, Asif Mohammed and Jorge Luis Rodriguez Meza. "How Prevalent Are Credit-Constrained Firms in the Formal Private Sector? Evidence Using Global Surveys". World Bank Policy Research Working Paper; no. WPS 10502). Firms are categorized into fully credit constrained, partially credit constrained, or credit unconstrained as illustrated in the appendix figure. Four sets of survey questions are used for the categorization: (i) whether the firm applied for a loan or line of credit (k16); (ii) if so, what was the outcome of this application (k17); (iii) if it did not apply, the reason for not applying (k20a1); and (iv) whether the firm has access to external finance (variables k3 and k5).

Firms are categorized as partially credit constrained if any of the following conditions are met: (1) the firm applied for a loan and the application was partially approved; (2) the firm applied for a loan and the application was rejected, but the firm has access to external sources of finance excluding any equity finance (k5i); or (3) the firm has external finance but did not apply for a loan due to any reason other than no need for it.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables: K.3a, K.5a, K3bc, K3e, K3f, K3hd, K5bc, K5e, K5f, K5hdj, K.4, K.5i, K.16, K.17, K.20a1

K.3	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital, that is the funds available for day-to-day operations, that were financed from each of the following sources? **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Internal funds or retained earnings	**k3a** %	**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	**k3bc** %	**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions, which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	**k3e** %	**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	**k3f** %	**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.	**k3hd** %	**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW

K.5	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion or **[Insert LCU]** amount of this establishment's total purchases of fixed assets that were financed from the following sources: **SHOW CARD 18**

	Percent	OR	Amount [Insert LCUs]	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Internal funds or retained earnings	k5a%		k5a1	-9
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares	k5i %		k5i1	-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	k5bc%		k5bc1	-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions, which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	k5e %		k5e1	-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	k5f %		k5f1	-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc.	k5hdj%		k5hdj1	-9
	100%		n5a+n5b	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100% OR THAT TOTAL SUM EQUALS TOTAL PURCHASES IN N5 UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW

K.4	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment purchase any new or used fixed assets, such as machinery, vehicles, equipment, land, or buildings?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9
	k4

K.16	Referring again to the last fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment apply for any loans or lines of credit?

Yes	1	*GO TO QUESTION K.20*
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	*GO TO QUESTION K.21*
	k16	

K.17	What was the **main** reason why this establishment did not apply for any line of credit or loan? **SHOW CARD 18**

No need for a loan – establishment had sufficient capital	1
Application procedures were complex	2
Interest rates were not favorable	3
Collateral requirements were too high	4
Size of loan and maturity were insufficient	5
Did not think it would be approved	6
Other	7
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9
	k17

K.20	Referring only to this most recent application for a line of credit or loan, what was the outcome of that application?

Application was approved in full	1
Application was approved in part	2
Application was rejected	3
Application was withdrawn	4
APPLICATION STILL IN PROCESS	**-6**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

k20a1

Notes

Indicator Updates	
June 26, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[fin34] Percent of firms that are partially or fully credit constrained

Description

Percent of firms that are categorized as partially or fully credit constrained. It is based on the sum of indicators fin23 and fin24.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables: K.3a, K.5a, K3bc, K3e, K3f, K3hd, K5bc, K5e, K5f, K5hdj, K.4, K.5i, K.16, K.17, K.20a1

K.3	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital, that is the funds available for day-to-day operations, that were financed from each of the following sources? **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Internal funds or retained earnings	**k3a** %	**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	**k3bc** %	**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions, which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	**k3e** %	**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	**k3f** %	**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.	**k3hd** %	**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW

K.5	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion or **[Insert LCU]** amount of this establishment's total purchases of fixed assets that were financed from the following sources: **SHOW CARD 18**

	Percent	**OR**	**Amount [Insert LCUs]**	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Internal funds or retained earnings	**k5a**%		**k5a1**	**-9**
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares	**k5i** %		**k5i1**	**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	**k5bc**%		**k5bc1**	**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions, which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	**k5e** %		**k5e1**	**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	**k5f** %		**k5f1**	**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc.	**k5hdj**%		**k5hdj1**	**-9**
	100%		**n5a+n5b**	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100% OR THAT TOTAL SUM EQUALS TOTAL PURCHASES IN N5
UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW

K.4	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment purchase any new or used fixed assets, such as machinery, vehicles, equipment, land, or buildings?

Yes	1	
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		k4

K.16	Referring again to the last fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment apply for any loans or lines of credit?

Yes	1	***GO TO QUESTION K.20***
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION K.21***
		k16

K.17	What was the **main** reason why this establishment did not apply for any line of credit or loan? **SHOW CARD 18**

No need for a loan – establishment had sufficient capital	1
Application procedures were complex	2
Interest rates were not favorable	3
Collateral requirements were too high	4
Size of loan and maturity were insufficient	5
Did not think it would be approved	6
Other	7
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
	k17

K.20	Referring only to this most recent application for a line of credit or loan, what was the outcome of that application?

Application was approved in full	1	
Application was approved in part	2	
Application was rejected	3	
Application was withdrawn	4	
APPLICATION STILL IN PROCESS	**-6**	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		k20a1

Notes

Indicator Updates	
July 10, 2026	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[fin25] Percent of firms that are credit unconstrained

Description

Indicator fin25 (along with fin23 and fin24) is based on Islam and Rodriguez Meza (2023, Islam, Asif Mohammed and Jorge Luis Rodriguez Meza. "How Prevalent Are Credit-Constrained Firms in the Formal Private Sector? Evidence Using Global Surveys". World Bank Policy Research Working Paper; no. WPS 10502). Firms are categorized into fully credit constrained, partially credit constrained, or credit unconstrained as illustrated in the appendix figure. Four sets of survey questions are used for the categorization: (i) whether the firm applied for a loan or line of credit (k16); (ii) if so, what was the outcome of this application (k17); (iii) if it did not apply, the reason for not applying (k20a1); and (iv) whether the firm has access to external finance (variables k3 and k5).

Firms are categorized as credit unconstrained if any of the following conditions are met: (1) the firm applied for a loan and the application was fully approved; or (2) the firm did not apply for a loan because it did not need it.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables: K.16, K.17 and K.20a1.

K.16	Referring again to the last fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment apply for any loans or lines of credit?

Yes	1	***GO TO QUESTION K.20***
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION K.21***
		k16

K.17	What was the **main** reason why this establishment did not apply for any line of credit or loan? **SHOW CARD 18**

No need for a loan – establishment had sufficient capital	1
Application procedures were complex	2
Interest rates were not favorable	3
Collateral requirements were too high	4
Size of loan and maturity were insufficient	5
Did not think it would be approved	6
Other	7
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
	k17

K.20	Referring only to this most recent application for a line of credit or loan, what was the outcome of that application?

Application was approved in full	1
Application was approved in part	2
Application was rejected	3
Application was withdrawn	4
APPLICATION STILL IN PROCESS	**-6**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

k20a1

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin15] Percent of firms with a checking or savings account

Description

Percentage of firms that have a checking or savings account.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.6.

K.6	Now let's talk about the establishment's current situation. At this time, does this establishment have a checking or savings account?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

k6

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin14] Percent of firms with a bank loan/line of credit

Description

Percentage of firms that have bank loans or line of credit.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.8.

K.8	At this time, does this establishment have a line of credit or a loan from a financial institution?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION K.15d***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION K.15d***
		k8

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin11] Average proportion of loans requiring collateral (%)

Description

Loans that require collateral for approval to get the financing.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables K.8 and K.13.

K.8	At this time, does this establishment have a line of credit or a loan from a financial institution?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION K.15d***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION K.15d***
		k8

K.13	Referring only to this most recent loan or line of credit, did the financing require collateral?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION K.15b***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION K.15b***
		k13

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin10] Average value of collateral needed for a loan (% of the loan amount)

Description

Value of collateral needed for a loan or line of credit as a percentage of the loan value or the value of the line of credit.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.11 and K.15a.

K.11	What was its value at the time of approval?

	LCUs
Size of most recent line of credit or loan approved	k11
REFUSAL (SPONTANEOUS)	**-8**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

K.15a	What was the approximate value of the collateral required?

	LCUs
Value of collateral	k15a
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables k15
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables k15
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin26] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting unfavorable rates, collateral, or procedures as main reason for not applying for loans

Description

Percentage of firms reporting unfavorable rates, collateral requirements were high, or procedures were complex as main reason for not applying for loans or line of credit

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.17.

K.17	What was the **main** reason why this establishment did not apply for any line of credit or loan? **SHOW CARD 20**

No need for a loan - establishment had enough capital	1	*GO TO K.21*
Application procedures were complex	2	*GO TO K.21*
Interest rates were not favorable	3	*GO TO K.21*
Collateral requirements were too high	4	*GO TO K.21*
Size of loan and maturity were insufficient	5	*GO TO K.21*
Did not think it would be approved	6	*GO TO K.21*
Other	7	*GO TO K.21*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	*GO TO K.21*
		k17

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin20] Percent of firms not needing a loan

Description

Percent of firms that did not apply for a loan because they had sufficient capital and did not need a loan.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.16 and K.17

K.16	Referring again to the last fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment apply for any loans or lines of credit?

Yes	1	***GO TO QUESTION K.20***
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION K.21***
		k16

K.17	What was the **main** reason why this establishment did not apply for any line of credit or loan? **SHOW CARD 18**

No need for a loan – establishment had sufficient capital	1
Application procedures were complex	2
Interest rates were not favorable	3
Collateral requirements were too high	4
Size of loan and maturity were insufficient	5
Did not think it would be approved	6
Other	7
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
	k17

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 1, 2012	Indicator Created

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin27] [B-READY] Average days to receive a decision on loan application

Description

Number of days from the moment of the loan application was submitted until the decision was received.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.32.

ASK IF K.16.2 IS 1 OR 3 (AT LEAST ONE APPLICATION FOR A LOAN) AND k20 IS NOT "STILL IN PROCESS"

K.32	How many days did it take from the moment the application was submitted until the decision was communicated?

	Days
Days to review loan application and receive a decision	**k32**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin21] Percent of firms whose recent loan application was rejected

Description

Percent of firms whose recent loan application was rejected.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.16 and K.20a1

K.16	Referring again to the last fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment apply for any loans or lines of credit?

Yes	1	***GO TO QUESTION K.20***
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION K.21***
		k16

K.20	Referring only to this most recent application for a line of credit or loan, what was the outcome of that application?

Application was approved in full	1	
Application was approved in part	2	
Application was rejected	3	
Application was withdrawn	4	
APPLICATION STILL IN PROCESS	**-6**	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		k20a1

Notes

Indicator Updates

April 17, 2012	Indicator Created
June 26, 2017	Variable k20 was revised and replaced with k20a1, which provided more specific options on the loan application.

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin12] Percent of firms using banks to finance investments

Description

Percentage of firms using banks to finance their fixed asset purchases, among firms that have purchased fixed assets.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.5bc

K.5	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's total purchase of fixed assets that was financed from each of the following sources: **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings		-9
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares		-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	k5bc%	-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions		-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin1] Average proportion of investment financed internally (%)

Description

Estimated proportion of fixed asset purchases that was financed from internal funds/retained earnings.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.5a.

K.5	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's total purchase of fixed assets that was financed from each of the following sources: **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings	k5a%	-9
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares		-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions		-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin2] Average proportion of investment financed by banks (%)

Description

Estimated proportion of fixed asset purchases financed by bank loans.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.5bc.

K.5	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's total purchase of fixed assets that was financed from each of the following sources: **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings		-9
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares		-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	k5bc%	-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions		-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin3] Average proportion of investment financed by supplier/customer credit (%)

Description

Estimated proportion of fixed asset purchases that was financed by suppliers credit and advances from customers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.5f.

K.5	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's total purchase of fixed assets that was financed from each of the following sources: **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings		-9
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares		-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions		-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	k5f%	-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin4] Average proportion of investment financed by equity or stock sales (%)

Description

Estimated proportion of fixed asset purchases that was financed through owners' contributions or new equity issuance.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.5i.

K.5	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's total purchase of fixed assets that was financed from each of the following sources: **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings		-9
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares	k5i%	-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions		-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin5] Average proportion of investment financed by other financing (%)

Description

Estimated proportion of fixed asset purchases that was financed by other sources, i.e. loans from non-bank financial institutions; issued new debt; moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables K.5e and K.5hdj.

K.5	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's total purchase of fixed assets that was financed from each of the following sources: **SHOW CARD 17**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings		-9
Owners' contribution or issued new equity shares		-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions	k5e%	-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, bonds, etc	k5hdj%	-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

February, 4 2011	Updated fin5 for ECA 2008/2009 countries using k5hdej.
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
Aug.28.2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin13] Percent of firms using banks to finance working capital

Description

Percentage of firms using bank loans to finance their working capital.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.3bc

K.3	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital that was financed from each of the following sources? **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 12**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings		-9
Borrowed from banks (private and state-owned)	k3bc %	-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies		-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin22] Percent of firms using supplier/customer credit to finance working capital

Description

Percentage of firms using credit from suppliers and advances from customers to finance their working capital.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.3f

K.3	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital, which is the funds available for day-to-day operations, that was financed from each of the following sources? **SHOW CARD 18**

	Percent	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Internal funds or retained earnings		**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies		**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	**k3f** %	**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.		**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin6] Average proportion of working capital financed internally (%)

Description

Proportion of the working capital that was financed by internal financing.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.3a.

K.3	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital that was financed from each of the following sources? **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 12**

	Percent	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Internal funds or retained earnings	**k3a** %	**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies		**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.		**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
May 29,2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin7] Average proportion of working capital financed by banks (%)

Description

Proportion of the working capital that was financed by bank loans.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.3bc.

K.3	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital that was financed from each of the following sources? **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 12**

	Percent	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Internal funds or retained earnings		**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	**k3bc** %	**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies		**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.		**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin8] Average proportion of working capital financed by supplier/customer credit (%)

Description

Proportion of the working capital that was financed by supplier credit and advances from customers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.3f.

K.3	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital that was financed from each of the following sources? **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 12**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Internal funds or retained earnings		-9
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		-9
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies		-9
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	k3f %	-9
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin9] Average proportion of working capital financed by other financing (%)

Description

Estimated proportion of the working capital that was financed by other financing, i.e. non-bank financial institutions; moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables K.3e and K.3hd.

K.3	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital that was financed from each of the following sources? **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 12**

	Percent	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Internal funds or retained earnings		**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned		**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	**k3e** %	**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers		**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.	**k3hd** %	**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
Aug 28, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin19] Average proportion of working capital financed externally (%)

Description

Proportion of the working capital that was financed by banks, suppliers, or other sources. This is the total of 3 indicators: fin7, fin8, and fin9.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.3bc, K.3e, K.3f, and K.3hd.

K.3	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, please estimate the proportion of this establishment's working capital that was financed from each of the following sources? **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 12**

	Percent	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Internal funds or retained earnings		**-9**
Borrowed from banks: private and state-owned	**k3bc** %	**-9**
Borrowed from non-bank financial institutions which include microfinance institutions, credit cooperatives, credit unions, or finance companies	**k3e** %	**-9**
Purchases on credit from suppliers and advances from customers	**k3f** %	**-9**
Other, moneylenders, friends, relatives, etc.	**k3hd** %	**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[t2] Percent of firms with an annual financial statement reviewed by external auditors

Description

Percentage of firms with their annual financial statements reviewed by external auditors.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.21.

K.21	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment have its annual financial statements checked and certified by an external auditor?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
	k21

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin28] [B-READY] Average proportion of sales paid by customers electronically

Description

Percentage of total sales for a typical month that was paid by customers through electronic payments, that is other than cash or check payments

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.33.

K.33	What percentage of total sales for a typical month does this establishment receive from its customers through electronic payments, that is other than cash or check payments?

	Percentage	
Percentage of sales through e-payments	k33	*IF 0, GO TO K.38*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	*GO TO K.38*

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin29] [B-READY] Average days to receive the main type of electronic payment

Description

Average number of days between electronic payment initiation and fund receipt

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.35.

K.35	How many days does it take on average from when payment is made until the money is received using **[insert the e-payment method to receive a payment identified in K.34]**?

	Days
Days to receive money	**k35**
PAYMENT RECEIVED IN LESS THAN A DAY	**0**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin30] [B-READY] Average cost to receive main type of electronic payment (% of transaction)

Description

As a percentage of a typical transaction, the cost to receive the electronic payment.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.36.

K.36	As a percentage of a typical transaction, how much does it cost to accept payments, using **[insert the e-payment method to receive a payment identified in K.34]**?

	As a percentage of payments	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Cost per transaction	**k36** %	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin31] [B-READY] Average proportion of payments made electronically

Description

The percentage of payments that is made electronically in a typical month, excluding payments to government and payroll.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.38.

K.38	What percentage of the total payments that this establishment makes in a typical month is done through electronic payments, that is other than cash or check payments, excluding payments to government and payroll?

	Percentage	
Percentage of purchases through e-payments	k38	*IF 0, GO TO K.30*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	*GO TO K.30*

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin32] [B-READY] Average cost to make main type of electronic payment (% of transaction)

Description

As a percentage of a typical transaction, the cost to make the electronic payment.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.40.

K.40	As a percentage of a typical transaction, how much does it cost to make payments, using **[Insert most important e-payment method to make a payment (option identified in K.39)]**?

	As a percentage of payments	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Cost per transaction	**k40** %	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin16] Percent of firms identifying access to finance as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying access of finance as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: k30==3 or 4 is coded as 100; k30 ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.30

K.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **Access to Finance** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 19**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Access to finance **k30**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin33] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of access to finance as a constraint

Description

Perceptions index of access to finance as a constraint on a scale of 0 to 100. For this indicator, 0 is assigned for "no obstacle", 25 for "minor" obstacle, 50 for "moderate" obstacle, 75 for "major" obstacle, and 100 for "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.30.

K.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **access to finance** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 22**

						(SPONTANEOUS)	
	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	DON'T KNOW	DOES NOT APPLY
Access to finance k30	0	1	2	3	4	-9	-7

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin17] Average proportion of sales that are pre-paid (%)

Description

Percentage of total annual sales of goods or services paid for before delivery.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.2 (k2a). Only created for global surveys before 2010.

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Paid for before the delivery?	K2a %	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

FINANCE

[fin18] Average proportion of sales sold on credit (%)

Description

Percentage of total annual sales of goods or services sold on credit.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.2c

K.2	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's total annual sales of its goods or services were paid for after delivery?

	Percent	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Paid for after delivery?	**K2c** %	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
Aug 28, 2014	This indicator was out of date and has been removed from ES website.

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

A strong infrastructure enhances the competitiveness of an economy and generates a business environment conducive to firm growth and development. Good infrastructure efficiently connects firms to their customers and suppliers, and enables the use of modern production technologies. Conversely, deficiencies in infrastructure create barriers to productive opportunities and increase costs for all firms, from micro enterprises to large multinational corporations.

The Enterprise Surveys capture the dual challenge of providing a strong infrastructure for electricity, water supply, internet connections, etc., and the development of institutions that effectively provide and maintain public services. These indicators show the extent to which firms are faced with failures in the provision of electricity and the effect of these failures on sales. Inadequate electricity supply can increase costs, disrupt production, and reduce profitability. Additionally, these indicators measure the efficiency of the water supply for the manufacturing sector. Many manufacturing sectors depend on reliable and efficient sources of water for their operations. The indicators can also be used to evaluate the efficiency of infrastructure services by quantifying the delays in obtaining electricity, water, and telephone connections. Service delays impose additional costs on firms and may act as barriers to entry and investment.

Climate plays a pivotal role in private sector development, influencing operational stability and long-term sustainability. The Enterprise Surveys capture measures such as the percentage of firms experiencing damage to physical assets due to extreme weather, which highlight the vulnerability of businesses to climate risks. Additionally, the Enterprise Surveys provides information about the share of firms monitoring their CO2 emissions and those adopting energy management measures, thus providing measures about the firms' proactive approach to mitigating environmental impact and ensuring resilient, sustainable growth.

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in16] Percent of firms experiencing electrical outages

Description

Percentage of firms that experienced power outages over the last complete fiscal year.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.6

C.6	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience power outages?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

c6

Notes

.

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in2] [B-READY] Average number of electrical outages in a typical month

Description

Average number of power outages in a typical month.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.6 and C.7. If the answer to C.6 is "No", then a zero is recorded for the number of power outages.

C.6	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience power outages?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION C.10***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION C.10***
		c6

C.7	In a typical month, over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many power outages did this establishment experience?

	Number	
Average number of power outages per month	**c7**	***IF 0, GO TO QUESTION C.10***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable c7
July 6, 2009	For Congo 2009 survey, replaced in2 as missing if the number of power outages reported is over 150, or the duration is over 24 hours.
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c7

Back to List of Indicators

[in3] [B-READY] Duration, in hours, of a typical electrical outage [median]

Description

Average duration of power outages (hours).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.7 and C.8. If the respondent answered c7=0, then average duration of power outages is recorded as 0.

C.7	In a typical month, over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many power outages did this establishment experience?

	Number
Average number of power outages per month	c7
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

IF 0, GO TO QUESTION C.10

C.8	How long did these power outages last on average?

	Hours	Minutes
Average duration of power outages	c8a	c8b
LESS THAN ONE MINUTE		**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable c8
November 10, 2009	Replace indicator value for in3 to be zero if the average number of power outages per month is zero.
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c8
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
June 26, 2017	Variable C8 was broken into hours and minutes with c8a and c8b.
June 3, 2024	Indicator is not calculated when c8b is "don't know"

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in3_c] If there were outages, average duration in hours of a typical electrical outage

Description

Average duration of power outages (hours) conditional on having a power outage.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.8, combination of c8a and c8b.

C.8	How long did these power outages last on average?

	Hours	Minutes
Average duration of power outages	c8a	c8b
LESS THAN ONE MINUTE		1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

November 10, 2009	Indicator Created
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c8
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
June 26, 2017	Variable C8 was broken into hours and minutes with c8a and c8b.
June 3, 2024	Indicator is not calculated when c8b is "don't know"

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in15] Average total time of power outages per month

Description

Average total time of power outages per month and includes zero values.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.7 and C.8, the latter is combination of c8a and c8b.

C.7	In a typical month, over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many power outages did this establishment experience?

	Number
Average number of power outages per month	**c7**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

IF 0, GO TO QUESTION C.10

C.8	How long did these power outages last on average?

	Hours	**Minutes**
Average duration of power outages	**c8a**	**c8b**
LESS THAN ONE MINUTE		**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable c7
August 20, 2009	Replace indicator in15 as 720 if the answers are more than 720 hours.
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c7
June 3, 2024	Indicator is not calculated when c8b is "don't know"

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in4] [B-READY] Losses due to electrical outages (% of annual sales) [median]

Description

Losses due to electrical outages, as percentage of total annual sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.9a. If the respondent answered C.9b, then the value was divided by sales (D.2).

C.9	Please estimate the losses that resulted from power outages either as a percentage of total annual sales or as total annual losses.

	Percent
Loss as percentage of total annual sales due to power outages	**c9a** %
None	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

PROVIDE EITHER ONE OR THE OTHER, NOT BOTH

	LCUs
Annual losses due to power outages	**c9b**
None	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, c9b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, c9a, c9b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
April 18, 2012	Indicator is altered to include all firms not just those who experienced at least one power outage. See indicator [in4_c] for losses among firms who experienced at least one power outage.
June 3, 2024	A coding typo was fixed that inadvertently imputed 0s when the indicator should not have been calculated, rounding to the nearest 0.5 was removed, and outlier routine was applied to the combination, not individual components.

Back to List of Indicators

[in4_c] If there were outages, average losses due to electrical outages (% of annual sales)

Description

If there were outages, average losses due to electrical outages, as percentage of total annual sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is calculated only for firms who responded yes to question C.6.This indicator is created from the variable C.9. If the respondent answered C.9B, then the value was divided by sales (D.2).

C.6	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience power outages?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION C.10***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION C.10***
		c6

C.9	Please estimate the losses that resulted from power outages either as a percentage of total annual sales or as total annual losses.

	Percent
Loss as percentage of total annual sales due to power outages	c9a %
None	0
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9

PROVIDE EITHER ONE OR THE OTHER, NOT BOTH

	LCUs
Annual losses due to power outages	c9b
None	0
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, c9b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, c9a, c9b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
June 3, 2024	A coding typo was fixed that inadvertently imputed 0s when the indicator should not have been calculated, rounding to the nearest 0.5 was removed, and outlier routine was applied to the combination, not individual components.

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in9] [B-READY] Percent of firms owning or sharing a generator

Description

Percentage of firms owning or sharing a generator.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.10.

C.10	Over the course of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment own or share a generator?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION C.12***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION C.12***
		c10

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

[in10] Average proportion of electricity from a generator (%)

Description

Percentage of electricity supplied from a generator or generators that the establishment owned or shared.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.10 and C.11.

C.10	Over the course of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment own or share a generator?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION C.12***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION C.12***
		c10

C.11	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's electricity came from a generator or generators that the establishment owned or shared?

	Percent
Percentage electricity from generators	**c11** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2014	Indicator was only being calculated for manufacturing firms. Now indicator is calculated for both Manufacturing and Service firms.
November 10,2009	Replace indicator in10 as zero if the establishment did not own or share a generator.
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c11

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in10_c] If a generator is used, average proportion of electricity from a generator (%)

Description

If a generator is used, what percentage of electricity comes from a generator

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.11

C.11	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's electricity came from a generator or generators that the establishment owned or shared?

	Percent
Percentage electricity from generators	**c11** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2014	Indicator was only being calculated for manufacturing firms. Now indicator is calculated for both Manufacturing and Service firms.
November 10, 2009	Indicator Created
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c11

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in1] [B-READY] Days to obtain an electrical connection, upon application

Description

There are two indicators measuring the duration to obtain an electrical connection: the average days required to obtain an electrical connection (in1), and the median number of days required to obtain an electrical connection (bready_in1_median). B-READY report uses the latter.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.4

C.4	In reference to that application for an electrical connection, approximately how many days did it take to obtain it from the day of the application to the day the service was received?

	Days
Wait for electrical connection	**c4**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable c4
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c4
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in12] Percent of firms identifying electricity as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying electricity as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. On a scale of 100, if firms choose "major" or "very severe" they score 100, and 0 otherwise.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.30a.

C.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **Electricity** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 4**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Don't Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Electricity **c30a**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in17] Percent of firms experiencing water insufficiencies*

Description

Percentage of firms that experienced insufficient water supply for production over the last complete fiscal year in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.15

C.15	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience insufficient water supply for production?

Yes	1
No	2
The establishment does not use water for production	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

c15

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in18] [B-READY] Percent of firms experiencing water insufficiencies

Description

Percentage of firms that experience insufficient water supply.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.152.

C.15.2	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** did this establishment experience insufficient water supply?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO C.22b***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO C.22b***
		c152

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[in6] Average number of water insufficiencies in a typical month*

Description

Average number of water shortages in a typical month in the last fiscal year in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.15 and C.16. If the answer to C.15 is "No", then a zero is recorded for the number of water insufficiencies in a typical month.

C.15	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience insufficient water supply for production?

Yes	1
No	2
The establishment does not use water for production	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

c15

C.16	In a typical month, over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many incidents of insufficient water supply did this establishment experience?

	Number
Average number of incidents of water insufficiency per month	**c16**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable c16
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c16
July 12, 2015	The indicator is updated to use c15 as a screener variable and the got corrected in following surveys: Afghanstan2014, Bangladesh2013, India2014, Nepal2013, Pakistan2013, China2012, and Malawi2014.

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in19] Average number of water insufficiencies in a typical month

Description

Average number of incidents of insufficient water supply in a typical month.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.162.

C.16.2	In a typical month, how many incidents of insufficient water supply did this establishment experience?

	Number	
Number of incidents of water insufficiency in a typical month	c162	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	*GO TO C.35*

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in20] Average duration, in hours, of a typical water shortage

Description

Average duration, in hours, of a typical water shortage.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.172.

C.17.2	How long did these incidents of insufficient water supply last on average (in hours)?

	Hours
Average duration of insufficient water supply	c172
LESS THAN ONE HOUR	1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[in7] Average duration, in hours, of insufficient water supplies*

Description

Average duration of the water shortage in hours in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.16 and C.17

C.16	In a typical month, over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many incidents of insufficient water supply did this establishment experience?

	Number
Average number of incidents of water insufficiency per month	c16
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9

IF 0, GO TO QUESTION C.18

C.17	How long did these incidents of insufficient water supply last on average?

	Hours
Average duration of insufficient water supply	c17
Less than one hour	1
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable c16
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c16
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in7_c] If there were shortages, Average Duration in hours of the Water Shortage*

Description

If there were shortages, average duration of the water shortage in hours in the manufacturing sector. Zero hours are not included.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.17

C.17	How long did these incidents of insufficient water supply last on average?

	Hours
Average duration of insufficient water supply	**c17**
Less than one hour	**1**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in5] [B-READY] Days to obtain a water connection

Description

There are two indicators measuring the duration to obtain a water connections: the average number of days required to obtain a water connection (in5), and the median number of days to obtain a water connection (bready_in5_median). B-READY report uses the latter.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.13.

C.13	In reference to that application for a water connection, approximately how many days did it take to obtain it from the day of the application to the day the service was received?

	Days
Wait for water connection	**c13**
Less than one day	**1**
Still in process	**-6**
Application denied	**-5**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable c13
December 15, 2009	For Cameroon 2006 and Cape Verde 2006 surveys, c13 was replaced with missing if c13 is larger than 180.
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable c13

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in21] [B-READY] Percent of firms experiencing internet disruptions

Description

Percentage of firms experience disruptions to their internet connection, including complete downtime and connection slowdowns.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.39.

C.39	Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** did this establishment experience any disruptions to its internet connection, including complete downtime and connection slowdowns? Please exclude disruptions that are directly due to power outages.

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO C.42***
THE ESTABLISHMENT DOES NOT HAVE AN INTERNET CONNECTION	**-7**	***GO TO C.42***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO C.42***
		c39

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in22] [B-READY] Days to obtain internet connection [median]

Description

Median number of days to obtain internet connection.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.37.

C.37	In reference to that application, approximately how many days did it take to obtain the fixed broadband connection from the day of the application to the day the service was received?

	Days
Wait for internet connection	c37
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**1**
STILL IN PROCESS	**-6**
APPLICATION DENIED	**-5**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in14] Average proportion of products lost to breakage or spoilage during shipping to domestic markets (%)*

Description

Percentage of products shipped to supply domestic markets lost due to breakage or spoilage in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables D.11.

D.11	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of value of products this establishment shipped to supply domestic markets was lost while in transit because of breakage or spoilage?

	Percent
Losses due to breakage or spoilage as percentage of the value of the products	**d11** %
No losses	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
No internal shipments made	**-7**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in11] Percent of firms identifying transportation as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying transportation as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: d30a==3 or 4 is coded as 100; d30a ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables D.30a.

D.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **Transport** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 8**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Don't Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Transport **d30a**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in23] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of transportation as a constraint

Description

Perceptions index of transportation as a constraint on a scale of 0 to 100. For this indicator, 0 is assigned for "no obstacle", 25 for "minor" obstacle, 50 for "moderate" obstacle, 75 for "major" obstacle, and 100 for "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.30a.

D.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree are each of the following an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS** **SHOW CARD 7**

						(SPONTANEOUS)	
	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	DON'T KNOW	DOES NOT APPLY
Transport **d30a**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in24] Percent of firms experiencing damage of physical assets due to extreme weather

Description

Percentage of firms that experience damage of physical assets due to extreme weather such as storms, floods, droughts or landslides.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable GE.3.

GE.3	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience damage of physical assets due to extreme weather events such as storms, floods, droughts or landslides?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO GE.7***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO GE.7***
		ge3

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in25] Percent of firms monitoring own CO2 emissions over last 3 years

Description

Percentage of firms tracking their own CO_2 emissions over the past three years

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable GE.7.

GE.7	Over the last three years, did this establishment monitor its CO_2 emissions?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

ge7

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLIMATE

[in26] Percent of firms adopting energy management measures to reduce emissions over last 3 years

Description

Share of companies adopting energy-saving practices to reduce emissions over the past three years."

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable GE.8d.

GE.8	Over the last three years, did this establishment adopt any energy management measures to reduce emissions, waste, or pollution?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS	**-7**

ge8d

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

The Enterprise Surveys provide indicators that describe several dimensions of gender composition in the workforce. It also collects information on the characteristics of the workforce employed in the non-agricultural private economy. The set of indicators presents the composition of the firm's workforce by type of contract and gender. Labor regulations have a direct effect on the type of employment favored by firms and they may have a different impact by gender. Other indicators present the composition of the workforce classified into temporary and permanent workers and reflect the participation of women in regular full time employment, along with the firms' inclusion of women in formal trainings.

GENDER

[gend1] Percent of firms with women participation in ownership

Description

Percentage of firms with females among the owners.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.4.

B.4	Amongst the owners of the firm, are there any females?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

b4

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend6] Percent of firms with majority women ownership

Description

Percentage of firms with majority female ownership (i.e., the ownership percentage is higher than 50).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.4 and B.4a. Exceptions are made for African surveys conducted between 2009 and 2011, where B.3a (or equivalently Afb.3a for certain surveys) was used instead. For B.3a (or Afb.3a) values of 3 (majority are women) and 4 (all women) are considered to be majority female-owned.

B.4	Amongst the owners of the firm, are there any females?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

b4

B.4a	What percentage of the firm is owned by females?

	Percentage
Percentage of female ownership	**b4a%**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

[For 24 African countries surveyed between 2009 and 2011]

B.3a	Are the owners of the firm:

All men	1
Majority are men	2
Majority are women	3
All women	4
Equally divided between men and women	5
Does not apply	**-7**
Don't know	**-9**

b3a

Notes

Indicator Updates

August 20 2015	Indicator created

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend4] Percent of firms with a woman top manager

Description

Percentage of firms with females as the top manager.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.7a.

B.7a	Is the Top Manager female?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
	b7a

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 17, 2009	Indicator created

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend7] [B-READY] Percent of firms owned or managed by women among those that held a government contract in last 3 years

Description

Percentage of firms owned or managed by women among those that held a government contract in last 3 years

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.42, B.4 and B.7a.

J.42	Over the last three years, has this establishment held a government contract?

Yes	1	
No	2	*GO TO J.7*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	*GO TO J.7*
		j42

B.4	Amongst the owners of the firm, are there any females?

Yes	1	
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		b4

B.7a	Is the Top Manager female?

Yes	1	
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		b7a

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend2] Average proportion of permanent full-time workers that are women (%)

Description

Share of permanent full-time workers that are female.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.5a, L.5b and L.5.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all paid employees that are contracted for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment contract and that work 8 or more hours per day) **(INTERVIEWER: include interviewee if applicable**).

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	**l1**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

L.5	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent full-time individuals working in this establishment in the following categories were female?

	Number	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Female permanent full-time production workers	**l5a**	**-9**
Female permanent full-time non-production workers	**l5b**	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables l1,l5a, l5b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables l1,l5a, l5b
June 3, 2024	Rounding to the nearest 0.5 was removed.

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend5] Average proportion of permanent full-time production workers that are women (%)*

Description

Percentage of permanent full-time production workers that are female in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.3a and L.5a.

L.3	At the end of the last complete fiscal year, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **(INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY)**

	Number	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Production workers	l3a	-9

L.5	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent full-time individuals working in this establishment in the following categories were female?

	Number	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Female permanent full-time production workers	l5a	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

February 3, 2014	Indicator created
June 3, 2024	Rounding to the nearest 0.5 was removed.

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend3] Average proportion of permanent full-time non-production workers that are women (%)*

Description

Percentage of permanent full-time non-production workers that are female in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.3b and L.5b.

L.3	At the end of the last complete fiscal year, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **(INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY)**

	Number	Don't know (spontaneous)
Non-production workers [e.g., managers, administration, sales]	l3b	-9

L.5	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent full-time individuals working in this establishment in the following categories were female?

	Number	Don't know (spontaneous)
Female permanent full-time non-production workers	l5b	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables l1, l5b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables l1, l5b
February 3, 2014	Replace l1 with l3b
June 3, 2024	Rounding to the nearest 0.5 was removed.

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend8] Average proportion of women workers offered formal training over last fiscal year (%)*

Description

Percentage of women workers in manufacturing sector offered formal training over last fiscal year.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.12a and L.12a1.

L.12	Referring to those training programs, what percentage of female, permanent, full-time workers received formal training? If easier, please provide the total numbers (provide one or the other but not both).

	Percent		Number	IF NO FEMALE WORKERS WERE TRAINED	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Female full-time permanent workers trained	l12a %	OR	l12a1	0	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
December 15, 2025	Correction to the code for converting l12a1 data into percentages

Back to List of Indicators

GENDER

[gend9] Average proportion of women workers offered formal training over last fiscal year (%, only service sector)

Description

Percentage of women workers in service sector offered formal training over last fiscal year.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.12a and L.12a1.

L.12	Referring to those training programs, what percentage of female, permanent, full-time workers received formal training? If easier, please provide the total numbers (provide one or the other but not both).

	Percent		Number	IF NO FEMALE WORKERS WERE TRAINED	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Female full-time permanent workers trained	l12a %	OR	l12a1	0	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
December 15, 2025	Correction to the code for converting l12a1 data into percentages

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

Open markets allow firms to expand, raise standards for efficiency on exporters, and enable firms to import low cost supplies. However, trading also forces firms to deal with customs services and trade regulations, obtain export and import licenses, and in some cases, firms also face additional costs due to losses during transport. The Enterprise Surveys collect information on the operational constraints faced by exporters and importers and quantifies the trade activity of firms. Indicators provide a measure of the intensity of foreign trade in the private sector.

TRADE

[tr10] Percent of firms exporting directly or indirectly at least 1% of sales

Description

Percentage of firms that export directly or indirectly.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables D.3b and D.3c.

D.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's sales were: **(INTERVIEWER: these must be asked in the order they appear on the table)** **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)	
National sales		-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.10*
Indirect exports (sold domestically to third party that exports products)	d3b %	-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
Direct exports	d3c %	-9	*IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
	100%		

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr15] Percent of firms exporting directly at least 1% of sales

Description

Percentage of Firms that Export Directly.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.3c.

D.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's sales were: **(INTERVIEWER: these must be asked in the order they appear on the table)** **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)	
National sales		-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.10*
Indirect exports (sold domestically to third party that exports products)		-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
Direct exports	d3c %	-9	*IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
	100%		

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 29, 2009	Indicator Created.
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr17] Percent of firms exporting directly or indirectly at least 10% of sales

Description

Percentage of firms that export directly or indirectly at least 10% of their total annual sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables D.3b and D.3c.

D.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's sales were: **(INTERVIEWER: these must be asked in the order they appear on the table)** **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
National sales		**-9**
Indirect exports (sold domestically to third party that exports products)	**d3b** %	**-9**
Direct exports	**d3c** %	**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr16] Percent of firms exporting directly at least 10% of sales

Description

Percentage of firms that export directly at least 10% of their total annual sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.3c.

D.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's sales were: **(INTERVIEWER: these must be asked in the order they appear on the table)** **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
National sales		**-9**
Indirect exports (sold domestically to third party that exports products)		**-9**
Direct exports	**d3c** %	**-9**
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr5] Average proportion of total sales that are exported directly (%)

Description

Sales exported directly as percentage of total sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.3c.

D.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's sales were: **(INTERVIEWER: these must be asked in the order they appear on the table)** **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)	
National sales		-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.10*
Indirect exports (sold domestically to third party that exports products)		-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
Direct exports	d3c%	-9	*IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
	100%		

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr6] Average proportion of total sales that are exported indirectly (%)

Description

Sales exported indirectly as percentage of total sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.3b.

D.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's sales were: **(INTERVIEWER: these must be asked in the order they appear on the table)** **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)	
National sales		-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.10*
Indirect exports (sold domestically to third party that exports products)	d3b%	-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
Direct exports		-9	*IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
	100%		

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr4] Average proportion of total sales that are domestic sales (%)

Description

Domestic sales as percentage of total sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.3a.

D.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's sales were: **(INTERVIEWER: these must be asked in the order they appear on the table)** **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)	
National sales	d3a %	-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.10*
Indirect exports (sold domestically to third party that exports products)		-9	*IF 100, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
Direct exports		-9	*IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.8*
	100%		

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr1] Average days to clear direct exports through customs*

Description

Average number of days to clear direct exports through customs in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.4 and D.33

D.4	In fiscal year **[a20y],** when this establishment exported goods directly, how many days did it take on average from the time this establishment's goods arrived at their main point of exit (e.g., port, airport) until the time these goods cleared customs?

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear customs	d4a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d4b**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**	***GO TO D.34.2***	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO D.33***	**-9**

ASK IF MANUFACTURING (d1a1a is 1) OR A WHOLESALER (d1a1a is 3)

D.33	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how many days did it take on average for these directly exported goods to be released by **all** border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of exit until the release of all goods? (Please include all clearance procedure times until the final release, including those times prior to arrival at the point of exit, not including transport time).

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear border control agencies	d33a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d33b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable d4
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable d4
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
August 21, 2023	Corrected code to exclude services as originally intended
July 21, 2025	Data corrected by excluding cases where customs clearance time for direct exports (d4) exceeds the total border clearance duration (d33).
September 22, 2025	In cases where d4a is less than a day and answer in terms of hours (d4b) is "don't know", 1 day is assigned (instead of excluding from calculations). This preserves backward consistency.

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr18] Days for exported goods to clear all border control agencies [median]

Description

Median number of days for exported goods to clear all border control agencies including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of exit.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.4, D.33a and D.33b.

D.4	In fiscal year **[a20y],** when this establishment exported goods directly, how many days did it take on average from the time this establishment's goods arrived at their main point of exit (e.g., port, airport) until the time these goods cleared customs?

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear customs	d4a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d4b**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**	***GO TO D.34.2***	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO D.33***	**-9**

ASK IF MANUFACTURING (d1a1a is 1) OR A WHOLESALER (d1a1a is 3)

D.33	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how many days did it take on average for these directly exported goods to be released by **all** border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of exit until the release of all goods? (Please include all clearance procedure times until the final release, including those times prior to arrival at the point of exit, not including transport time).

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear border control agencies	d33a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d33b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
July 21, 2025	Corrected by excluding cases where (i) customs clearance time for direct exports (d4) exceeds the total border clearance duration (d33a or d33b), or (ii) total clearance is reported as less than one day (d33a) but lacks hourly data (d33b).
September 22, 2025	In cases where d33a is less than a day and answer in terms of hours (d33b) is "don't know", 0.5 days are assigned (instead of excluding from calculations).

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr18_u] [B-READY] Average days for all exported goods to clear all border control agencies

Description

Average number of days for exported goods to clear all border control agencies including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of exit. In cases where the response to D.4a is "Does Not Apply", the value of 0 is assigned, reflecting the absence of clearance obligations.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.4, D.33a and D.33b.

D.4	In fiscal year **[a20y],** when this establishment exported goods directly, how many days did it take on average from the time this establishment's goods arrived at their main point of exit (e.g., port, airport) until the time these goods cleared customs?

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear customs	d4a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d4b**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**	***GO TO D.34.2***	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO D.33***	**-9**

ASK IF MANUFACTURING (d1a1a is 1) OR A WHOLESALER (d1a1a is 3)

D.33	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how many days did it take on average for these directly exported goods to be released by **all** border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of exit until the release of all goods? (Please include all clearance procedure times until the final release, including those times prior to arrival at the point of exit, not including transport time).

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear border control agencies	d33a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d33b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

September 22, 2025	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr19] [B-READY] Percent of firms that export at least some products via parcel service

Description

Percentage of firms that export at least some products via mail parcel or courier service.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.35.

ASK IF MANUFACTURING (d1a1a is 1) OR A WHOLESALER (d1a1a is 3)

D.35	Were any of the goods directly exported ordered through electronic means and shipped by mail parcel or courier service? Please consider only consignments valued below the de minimis threshold of the destination country.

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO D.8***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO D.8***
		d35

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr20] [B-READY] Average of typical costs to comply with all export requirements (% of value of goods exported)

Description

As a percentage of the value of goods exported directly, the average cost of complying with all export requirements, including customs fees, other required payments, and payments made to customs brokers or freight forwarders, transportation freight, trade finance and insurance services.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.34.

ASK IF MANUFACTURING (d1a1a is 1) OR A WHOLESALER (d1a1a is 3)

D.34	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** as a percentage of the value of the products exported directly, what was the average cost of complying with all export requirements, including customs fees, other required payments, and payments made to customs brokers or freight forwarders, transportation freight, trade finance and insurance services? Please use the incoterm FCA.

	Percent
FCA Costs to comply with export requirements	**d34**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr12] Average value of products exported directly lost due to theft (%)

Description

Loses of the products shipped to international markets while in transit because of theft (computed as percentage of the consignment values).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.6.

D.6	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of the value of the products exported directly was lost while in transit because of theft?

	Percent
Losses due to theft as percentage of the value of the products	**d6** %
No losses	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr13] Average value of products exported directly lost due to breakage or spoilage (%)

Description

Loses of the products shipped to international markets while in transit due to breakage or spoilage, computed as percentage of the consignment values.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.7.

D.7	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of the value of the products exported directly was lost while in transit because of breakage or spoilage?

	Percent
Losses due to breakage or spoilage as percentage of the value of the products	**d7** %
No losses	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr11] Percent of firms using material inputs and/or supplies of foreign origin*

Description

Percentage of firms that use material inputs and/or supplies of foreign origin in the manufacturing sector

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.12b.

D.12	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, as a proportion of all material inputs or supplies purchased that year, what percentage of this establishment's material inputs or supplies were: **SHOW CARD 7**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)	
laterial inputs or supplies of domestic origin		-9	
laterial inputs or supplies of foreign origin	d12b %	-9	*IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.16*
	100%		

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr21] Percent of firms using material inputs and/or supplies of foreign origin

Description

Percentage of firms using material inputs and/or supplies of foreign origin.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.12b.

D.12	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, as a proportion of all material inputs or supplies purchased that year, what percentage of this establishment's material inputs or supplies were: **SHOW CARD 7**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)	
laterial inputs or supplies of domestic origin		-9	
laterial inputs or supplies of foreign origin	d12b %	-9	*IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.16*
	100%		

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
July 21, 2025	The indicator is updated using d12b for computation instead of d13.

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr8] Average proportion of total inputs that are of foreign origin (%)*

Description

Percentage of material inputs and/or supplies of foreign origin in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.12b.

D.12	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, as a proportion of all material inputs or supplies purchased that year, what percentage of this establishment's material inputs or supplies were: **SHOW CARD 7**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Material inputs or supplies of domestic origin		-9
Material inputs or supplies of foreign origin	d12b %	-9
	100%	

IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.16

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr22] Average proportion of total inputs that are of foreign origin (%)

Description

The proportion of firms purchases of material inputs or supplies are of foreign origin.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.12b.

D.12	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** what percentage of this establishment's purchases of material inputs or supplies were: **SHOW CARD 6**

	Percent	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	
Of foreign origin	d12b %	-9	*IF 0, GO TO D.30*

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr7] Average proportion of total inputs that are of domestic origin (%)*

Description

Percentage of material inputs and/or supplies of domestic origin in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.12a.

D.12	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, as a proportion of all material inputs or supplies purchased that year, what percentage of this establishment's material inputs or supplies were: **SHOW CARD 7**

	Percent	Don't know (spontaneous)
Material inputs or supplies of domestic origin	**d12a** %	**-9**
Material inputs or supplies of foreign origin		**-9**
	100%	

IF 0, GO TO QUESTION D.16

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr2] Average days to clear imports from customs*

Description

Average number of days to clear imports from customs in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.14 and D.40

D.14	When this establishment imported these material inputs or supplies **[or finished goods and materials purchased to resell]**, how many days did it take on average from the time these goods arrived at their point of entry (e.g., port, airport) until the time these goods could be claimed from customs?

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear customs	d14a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d14b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**	***GO TO D.41***	

D.40	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how long did it take on average for these directly imported material inputs and supplies **[or finished goods and materials purchased to resell]** to be released by **all** border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of entry until all material inputs and supplies were released? (Please include all clearance procedure times until the release, including those times prior to arrival at the point of entry).

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear border control agencies	d40a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d40b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable d14
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable d14
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
July 21, 2025	Corrected by excluding cases where Customs clearance time for imports (d14) exceeds total border clearance duration (d40)
September 22, 2025	In cases where d14a is less than a day and answer in terms of hours (d14b) is "don't know", 1 day is assigned (instead of excluding from calculations). This preserves backward consistency.

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr23] Average days to clear imports from customs

Description

Average number of days to clear imports from customs.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.14a and D.14b.

D.14	When this establishment imported these material inputs or supplies **[or finished goods and materials purchased to resell]**, how many days did it take on average from the time these goods arrived at their point of entry (e.g., port, airport) until the time these goods could be claimed from customs?

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear customs	d14a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d14b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**	***GO TO D.41***	

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
July 21, 2025	Computation is based on d14 which is broken into days (d14a) and hours (d14b)
September 22, 2025	In cases where d14a is less than a day and answer in terms of hours (d14b) is "don't know", 1 day is assigned (instead of excluding from calculations). This preserves backward consistency.

Back to List of Indicators

[tr24] Days for imported goods to clear all border control agencies [median]

Description

Median number of days for imported goods to be released by all border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of entry until all material inputs and supplies were released.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables D14, D.40a and D.40b.

D.14	When this establishment imported these material inputs or supplies **[or finished goods and materials purchased to resell]**, how many days did it take on average from the time these goods arrived at their point of entry (e.g., port, airport) until the time these goods could be claimed from customs?

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear customs	d14a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d14b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**	***GO TO D.41***	

D.40	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how long did it take on average for these directly imported material inputs and supplies **[or finished goods and materials purchased to resell]** to be released by **all** border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of entry until all material inputs and supplies were released? (Please include all clearance procedure times until the release, including those times prior to arrival at the point of entry).

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear border control agencies	d40a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d40b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
July 21, 2025	Corrected by excluding cases where Customs clearance time for imports (d14) exceeds total border clearance duration (d40).
September 22, 2025	In cases where d40a is less than a day and answer in terms of hours (d40b) is "don't know", 0.5 days are assigned (instead of excluding from calculations).

Back to List of Indicators

[tr24_u] [B-READY] Average days for all imported goods to clear all border control agencies

Description

Average number of days for imported goods to be released by all border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of entry until all material inputs and supplies were released. In cases where the response to D.14 is "Does Not Apply", the value of 0 is assigned, reflecting the absence of clearance obligations.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.40a and D.40b.

D.14	When this establishment imported these material inputs or supplies **[or finished goods and materials purchased to resell]**, how many days did it take on average from the time these goods arrived at their point of entry (e.g., port, airport) until the time these goods could be claimed from customs?

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear customs	d14a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d14b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**	***GO TO D.41***	

D.40	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how long did it take on average for these directly imported material inputs and supplies **[or finished goods and materials purchased to resell]** to be released by **all** border control agencies, including clearance procedures prior to arrival at the point of entry until all material inputs and supplies were released? (Please include all clearance procedure times until the release, including those times prior to arrival at the point of entry).

	Days		Hours
Average duration to clear border control agencies	d40a		
LESS THAN ONE DAY	**0**	***IF LESS THAN 1 DAY***	**d40b**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**		**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

September 22, 2025	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr25] [B-READY] Average of typical costs to comply with all import requirements (% of value of goods imported)

Description

As a percentage of the value of the products directly imported, the average cost to comply with all import requirements, including customs fees, other required payments, and payments made to customs brokers or freight forwarders.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.41.

D.41	In fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** as a percentage of the value of the products directly imported, what was the average cost to comply with all import requirements, including customs fees, other required payments, and payments made to customs brokers or freight forwarders? Please use the incoterm DAP.

	Percent
DAP Costs to comply with import requirements	**d41**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr9] Percent of firms identifying customs and trade regulations as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying customs and trade regulations as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: d30b==3 or 4 is coded as 100; d30b ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.30b.

D.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **Customs and Trade Regulation** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 8**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Don't Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Transport	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**
Customs and trade regulations **d30b**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

TRADE

[tr26] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of customs and trade regulations as a constraint

Description

Perceptions index of customs and trade regulations as a constraint on a scale of 0 to 100. For this indicator, 0 is assigned for "no obstacle", 25 for "minor" obstacle, 50 for "moderate" obstacle, 75 for "major" obstacle, and 100 for "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.30b.

D.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree are each of the following an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS** **SHOW CARD 7**

						(SPONTANEOUS)	
	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**DON'T KNOW**	**DOES NOT APPLY**
Customs and trade regulations **d30b**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

Competition is vital to private sector development, fostering innovation, efficiency, and growth. The Enterprise Surveys provide multiple measures of market competition, such as, the number of competitors as reported by firms themselves. A healthy competitive environment is indicated by a higher percentage of firms reporting more than five competitors in their main product's market, reducing the likelihood of monopolistic practices and promoting consumer choice.

Public procurement practices significantly impact private sector growth. Firms' perceptions of the difficulty in complying with government contract tender requirements reflect the accessibility and transparency of public procurement processes. Simplified, fair, and transparent tender requirements encourage more firms to participate, fostering competition and ensuring better value for public spending.

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp1] [B-READY] Average index of market share of the largest competitor (excluding firms whose main market is international)

Description

The market share of firms' largest competitor, in terms of sales, in the market where these firms sold their main product or offered their main service. The index is defined over a 100 point scale using the variable e312: 0 if the market is dominated by one firm (e312=1), 50 if the market is dominated by a few firms (e312=2), and 100 if there is competition among many firms.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable E.31a and E.31b.

IF E.1 IS INTERNATIONAL (3), GO TO E.6

E.31.2	Which of the following best describes this main market? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT**

The market is dominated by one firm	1	
The market is dominated by a few firms	2	
There is competition among many firms	3	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		e312

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp2] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting less than two competitors in their main product's main market (excluding firms whose main market is international)

Description

Percentage of firms reporting less than two competitors in their main product's main market.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable e2b.

E.2	How many competitors did this establishment's main product [or service] face in this main market?

Number of competitors	e2b
TOO MANY TO COUNT	-4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp3] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting between two and five (inclusive) competitors in their main product's main market (excluding firms whose main market is international)

Description

Percentage of firms reporting between two and five (inclusive) competitors in their main product's main market.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable e2b.

E.2	How many competitors did this establishment's main product **[or service]** face in this main market?

Number of competitors	e2b
TOO MANY TO COUNT	**-4**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp4] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting more than five competitors in their main product's main market (excluding firms whose main market is international)

Description

Percentage of firms reporting more than five competitors in their main product's main market.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable e2b.

E.2	How many competitors did this establishment's main product [or service] face in this main market?

Number of competitors	e2b
TOO MANY TO COUNT	-4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp5] [B-READY] Percent of firms that cannot increase prices more than competitors without losing customers

Description

Percentage of firms that cannot increase prices more than competitors without losing customers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable E.33.

E.33	In this main market, can this establishment increase its prices more than its competitors can without losing customers?

Yes	1
No	2
PRICES ARE REGULATED	**-7**
PRICES ARE SET BY HEADQUARTERS	**-6**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

e33

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp6] [B-READY] Percent of firms reporting that their prices are regulated

Description

Percentage of firms reporting their prices are regulated.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable E.33.

E.33	In this main market, can this establishment increase its prices more than its competitors can without losing customers?

Yes	1
No	2
PRICES ARE REGULATED	**-7**
PRICES ARE SET BY HEADQUARTERS	**-6**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

e33

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp7] [B-READY] Average index of change of level of competition over last year

Description

Index of change of level of competition over last year. 0 is assigned for competition decreased, 50 for no change and 100 for competition increased.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable E.32.

E.32	Over the last year, has the level of competition in the market where this establishment sold its main product or offered its main service changed? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT**

Increased	1	
Decreased	2	
Stayed the same	3	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		e32

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp8] [B-READY] Average index of difficulty to switch internet providers

Description

Index of difficulty to switch internet providers. 100 is assigned to no difficulty at all, 50 for some or little difficulty and 0 for unable to change.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.42.

C.42	Using the responses on the card, please indicate how difficult would it be for this establishment to switch between internet providers? **SHOW CARD 3**

Unable to change the provider	1
With some difficulty	2
With little difficulty	3
With no difficulty at all	4
THERE IS ONLY ONE AVAILABLE INTERNET PROVIDER	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

c42

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

COMPETITION AND PUBLIC PROCUREMENT

[comp9] [B-READY] Average perceptions of the degree of difficulty to comply with government contract tender requirements

Description

Perceptions of the degree of difficulty to comply with government contract tender requirements. For this indicator, 0 is assigned for "not difficult at all", 33 for "somewhat difficult", 66 for "moderately difficult", and 100 for "very difficult".

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.41.

J.41	How difficult does this establishment find the administrative requirements to participate in a public tender? Please consider the time and resources that the establishment used in order to prepare a bid. **SHOW CARD 25**

Very difficult	1
Moderately difficult	2
Somewhat difficult	3
Not difficult at all	4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

j41

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

Corruption by public officials may present a major administrative and financial burden on firms. Corruption creates an unfavorable business environment by undermining the operational efficiency of firms and raising the costs and risks associated with doing business.

Inefficient regulations constrain firm efficiency as they present opportunities for soliciting bribes where firms are required to make "unofficial" payments to public officials to get things done. In many countries bribes are common and quite high and they add to the bureaucratic costs in obtaining required permits and licenses. They can be a serious impediment for firms' growth and development.

The Enterprise Surveys include several indicators for corruption. The Bribery depth reflects the proportion of times a firm was asked or expected to pay a bribe when soliciting six different public services, permits or licenses. Other indicators identify the extent to which specific regulatory and administrative officials require bribe payments during meetings with tax inspectors or to secure a government contract. Another set of indicators focuses on bribes to obtain specific licenses or permits, and shows the share of firms that are expected to make informal payments to secure import and operating licenses and to obtain a construction permit

[graft3] Bribery incidence (percent of firms experiencing at least one bribe payment request)

Description

The percent of firms experiencing at least one bribe payment request across 6 public transactions dealing with utilities access, permits, licenses, and taxes. The six public transaction questions are listed below. For purposes of computation, a refusal to answer a particular survey question is considered an affirmative answer.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.5., C.14, G.4, J.5, J.12, J.15

C.5	In reference to that application for an electrical connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9
REFUSE (spontaneous)	-8
	c5

C.14	In reference to that application for a water connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9
REFUSE (spontaneous)	-8
	c14

G.4	In reference to that application for a construction-related permit, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9
REFUSE (spontaneous)	-8
	g4

J.5	In any of these inspections or meetings (with tax officials) was a gift or informal payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9
REFUSE (spontaneous)	-8
	j5

J.12	In reference to that application for an import license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9
REFUSE (spontaneous)	-8

j12

J.15	In reference to that application for an operating license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9
Refusal (spontaneous)	-8

j15

Notes

Indicator Updates	
April 18, 2012	Indicator Created

Back to List of Indicators

[graft2] Average bribery depth (% of public transactions where a gift or informal payment was requested)

Description

The depth of Bribery is the percentage of instances in which a firm was either expected or requested to provide a gift or informal payment during solicitations for public services, licenses or permits. This measure uses data from 6 survey questions for each firm. For purposes of computation, a refusal to answer a particular survey question is considered an affirmative answer.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.5, C.14, G.4, J.5, J.12, J.15

C.5 In reference to that application for an electrical connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

c5

C.14 In reference to that application for a water connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

c14

G.4 In reference to that application for a construction-related permit, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

g4

J.5 In any of these inspections or meetings (with tax officials) was a gift or informal payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

j5

J.12	In reference to that application for an import license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

j12

J.15	In reference to that application for an operating license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**

j15

Notes

Indicator Updates	
August 18, 2011	Indicator Created. Bribery depth is computed similarly as the Graft Index from A. Gonzalez et al. 2007. World Bank Policy Research Working Paper #4394. Unlike the Graft Index, Bribery depth does not include telephone connections transactions and does include transactions conducted during meetings with tax officials. Another difference is that Bribery depth is calculated at the firm-level unlike the Graft Index which is calculated at the country-level.

Back to List of Indicators

[graft1] Average graft index

Description

This measure is based on A. Gonzalez et al. 2007. World Bank Policy Research Working Paper #4394, and is a precursor of graft2. Graft Index is the percentage of instances in which a firm was either expected or requested to provide a gift or informal payment during solicitations for public services, licenses or permits. This measure uses data from 6 survey questions for each firm. For purposes of computation, a refusal to answer a particular survey question is considered an affirmative answer. Unlike graft2, which was created later, graft1 includes telephone connections and excludes meetings with tax officials.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables C.21, C.5, C.14, G.4, J.12, and J.15

C.21 In reference to that application for a telephone connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

c5

C.5 In reference to that application for an electrical connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

c5

C.14 In reference to that application for a water connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

c14

G.4 In reference to that application for a construction-related permit, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

g4

J.12 In reference to that application for an import license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

j12

J.15	In reference to that application for an operating license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**

j15

Notes

Indicator Updates	

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr1] Percent of firms expected to give gifts in meetings with tax officials

Description

Percentage of firms expected to give gifts or informal payments during meetings with tax officials.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.5.

J.5	In any of these inspections or meetings was a gift or informal payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**

j5

Notes

Indicator Updates

December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected j5
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

[corr2] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to secure government contract

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider that firms with characteristics similar to theirs are making informal payments or giving gifts to public officials to secure government contract.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.6 and J.6a.

J.6a	Over the last year, has this establishment secured or attempted to secure a government contract?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION J.7***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION J.7***
		j6a

J.6	When establishments like this one do business with the government, what percent of the contract value would be typically paid in informal payments or gifts to secure the contract?

	Percent
Percent of the contract value paid as informal payments or gifts	**j6** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**
No payments	**0**

Notes

Indicator Updates

November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable j6
December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected j6
December 7, 2010	Treatment of -9 Change affected j6a
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
May 1, 2014	Refusals to j6 erroneously not incorporated

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr3] Average value of gift expected to secure a government contract (% of contract value)

Description

Percentage of contract value expected as a gift to secure government contract. Only firms that have confirmed that they have secured or attempted to secure a government contract in the last 12 months were required to answer this question.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.6.

J.6	When establishments like this one do business with the government, what percent of the contract value would be typically paid in informal payments or gifts to secure the contract?

	Percent
Percent of the contract value paid as informal payments or gifts	**j6** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**
No payments	**0**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, question J.6 was asked to all firms, regardless of whether or not the firm had secured or attempted to secure a government contract (question J.6a which precedes J.6).

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable j6
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable j6
December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected j6
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr10] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get an operating license

Description

Percentage of firms expected to give gifts or informal payments to get an operating license. Spontaneous refusals to the question are treated as a "Yes".

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.15.

J.15	In reference to that application for an operating license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**

j15

Notes

Indicator Updates

December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected j15

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr9] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get an import license

Description

Percentage of firms expected to give gifts or informal payments to get an import license.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.12.

J.12	In reference to that application for an import license, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

j12

Notes

Indicator Updates

December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected j12

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr8] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get a construction permit

Description

Percentage of firms expected to give gifts or informal payments to get a construction permit.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable G.4.

G.4	In reference to that application for a construction-related permit, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

g4

Notes

Indicator Updates

December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected g4

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr6] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get an electrical connection

Description

Percentage of firms expected to give gifts or informal payments to get an electrical connection.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.5.

C.5	In reference to that application for an electrical connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**
	c5

Notes

Indicator Updates

December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected c5

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr7] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to get a water connection

Description

Percentage of firms expected to give gifts or informal payments to get a water connection.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.14.

C.14	In reference to that application for a water connection, was an informal gift or payment expected or requested?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
REFUSE (spontaneous)	**-8**

c14

Notes

Indicator Updates

December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected c14

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr4] Percent of firms expected to give gifts to public officials "to get things done"

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider that firms with characteristics similar to theirs are making informal payments or giving gifts to public officials to "get things done" with regard to customs, taxes, licenses, regulations, services etc.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.7. If either j7a or j7b is positive, then the firm is considered to pay. If the respondent answers -8, it is also interpreted that the firm pays.

J.7	It is said that establishments are sometimes required to make gifts or informal payments to public officials to "get things done" with regard to customs, taxes, licenses, regulations, services etc. On average, what percentage of total annual sales, or estimated total annual value, do establishments like this one pay in informal payments or gifts to public officials for this purpose?

	Percent
Percentage of total annual sales paid as informal payment	**j7a** %
No payments or gifts are paid	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**

PROVIDE EITHER ONE OR THE OTHER, NOT BOTH

	LCUs
Total annual informal payment	**j7b**
No payments or gifts are paid	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
Refusal (spontaneous)	**-8**

Notes

Indicator Updates

September 7, 2010	Consideration of an answer of -8 (Refusal) as the firm pays informal payments
December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected outlier treatment on the variable j7a
December 7, 2010	Treatment of -8 Change affected outlier treatment on the variable j7b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr11] Percent of firms identifying corruption as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying corruption as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.30f.

J.30	As I list some factors that can affect the current operations of a business, please look at this card and tell me the degree to which you think each factor is an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment. **SHOW CARD 21**

ROTATE OPTIONS	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Corruption **j30f**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

INFORMALITY

A large informal sector has serious consequences for the formal private sector. The informal sector may pose unfair competition for formal firms. The Enterprise Surveys capture key dimensions the degree of informality in an economy. For example, the set of indicators (unregistered start-ups) shows the percentage of firms that started operation without being formally registered. It approximates the prevalence of informality in the private economy.

INFORMALITY

[infor1] Percent of firms competing against unregistered or informal firms

Description

Percentage of firms competing against unregistered or informal firms.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable E.11.

E.11	Does this establishment compete against unregistered or informal firms?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

e11

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

INFORMALITY

[infor4] Percent of firms formally registered when they started operations

Description

Percentage of firms formally registered when they started operations in the country.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.6a.

B.6a	Was this establishment formally registered when it began operations?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

b6a

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

[infor5] Average number of years firm operated without formal registration

Description

Average number of years firms operated without formal registration. This indicator is computed only for the firms that did not have a formal registration when they started their operations in the country.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.5, B.6a, and B.6b.

B.5	In what year did this establishment begin operations?

	Year	Answer from previous round
Year establishment began operations	b5	
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9	

INTERVIEWER: PROVIDE FOUR DIGITS FOR YEAR

B.6a	Was this establishment formally registered when it began operations?

Yes	1	
No	2	
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9	
		b6a

B.6b	In what year was this establishment formally registered?

	Year	Answer from previous round
Year establishment formally registered	b6b	
Don't know (spontaneous)	-9	
Never registered (spontaneous)	-7	

INTERVIEWER: PROVIDE FOUR DIGITS FOR YEAR.

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

INFORMALITY

[infor2] Percent of firms identifying practices of competitors in the informal sector as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying practices of competitors in the informal sector as major constraint. The computation of the indicator is based on the rating of the obstacle as a potential constraint to the current operations of the establishment.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable E.30.

E.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree are **Practices of Competitors in the Informal Sector** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 10**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Practices of competitors in the informal sector **e30**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

Robust dispute resolution and contract enforcement mechanisms are essential for private sector development, as they ensure the predictability and security of commercial transactions. A high percentage of firms experiencing commercial disputes highlights the need for effective mechanisms to address conflicts and uphold contractual obligations. Efficient dispute resolution systems, including courts, arbitration, mediation, and conciliation, provide businesses with avenues to resolve conflicts, maintain relationships, and secure their investments. The Enterprise Surveys provide multiple quantitative and qualitative measures of the business environment measures relevant to dispute resolution, and contract enforcement in general, including several measures of firms' perceptions about the courts, and alternative dispute resolution mechanisms.

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

[disp1] Percent of firms that had any commercial dispute

Description

Percentage of firms that had any commercial dispute.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable O.1.

O.1	In the last three years, has this establishment had any commercial dispute, that is a failure of any party to meet the terms or expectations of an agreement, including a contract, or a business relationship?

Yes	1	
No	2	*GO TO O.3*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	*GO TO O.3*
		o1

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

[disp2] Percent of firms that use courts, arbitration, mediation, or conciliation to resolve or attempt to resolve its commercial disputes

Description

Percentage of firms that use courts, arbitration, mediation, or conciliation to resolve or attempt to resolve its commercial disputes.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable O.2.

O.2	Did this establishment use courts, arbitration, mediation, or conciliation to resolve or attempt to resolve its commercial disputes?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
	o2

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

[disp3] [B-READY] Average perceptions of courts being independent and impartial in resolving commercial disputes

Description

Perceptions of courts being independent and impartial in resolving commercial disputes. 0 is assigned for "strongly" or "tend to" agree, and 100 for "strongly" or "tend to" disagree.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.31.

J.31	Please tell me if you strongly disagree, tend to disagree, tend to agree, or strongly agree with the statement: "In resolving commercial disputes, courts are independent and impartial". **SHOW CARD 23**

					(SPONTANEOUS)	
	Strongly disagree	Tend to disagree	Tend to agree	Strongly agree	DON'T KNOW	DOES NOT APPLY
"In resolving commercial disputes, courts are independent and impartial" j31	1	2	3	4	-9	-7

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

[disp4] [B-READY] Average perceptions of arbitration being a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes

Description

Perceptions of arbitration being a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes. 0 is assigned for "strongly" or "tend to" agree, and 100 for "strongly" or "tend to" disagree.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable O.3a.

O.3	Using the scale on the card, please indicate to what extent you agree with the following statements in relation **to commercial disputes**. **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS** **SHOW CARD 8**

					(SPONTANEOUS)	
	Strongly disagree	**Tend to disagree**	**Tend to agree**	**Strongly agree**	**DOES NOT APPLY**	**DON'T KNOW**
Arbitration is a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes **o3a**	1	2	3	4	**-7**	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

[disp5] [B-READY] Average perceptions of mediation being a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes

Description

Perceptions of mediation being a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes. 0 is assigned for "strongly" or "tend to" agree, and 100 for "strongly" or "tend to" disagree.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable O.3b.

O.3	Using the scale on the card, please indicate to what extent you agree with the following statements in relation **to commercial disputes**. **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS** **SHOW CARD 8**

					(SPONTANEOUS)	
	Strongly disagree	**Tend to disagree**	**Tend to agree**	**Strongly agree**	**DOES NOT APPLY**	**DON'T KNOW**
Mediation or conciliation is a reliable alternative to courts for resolving commercial disputes **o3b**	1	2	3	4	**-7**	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

[crime9] Percent of firms identifying the courts as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying the functioning of the courts as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: h30==3 or 4 is coded as 100; h30 ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable h.30.

J.30	As I list some factors that can affect the current operations of a business, please look at this card and tell me the degree to which you think each factor is an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment. **SHOW CARD 21**

ROTATE OPTIONS	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Courts **h30**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

DISPUTE RESOLUTION

[disp6] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of courts as a constraint

Description

Perceptions index of courts as a constraint on a scale of 0 to 100. For this indicator, 0 is assigned for "no obstacle", 25 for "minor" obstacle, 50 for "moderate" obstacle, 75 for "major" obstacle, and 100 for "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable H.30.

J.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree are each of the following an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS** **SHOW CARD 26**

						(SPONTANEOUS)	
	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**DON'T KNOW**	**DOES NOT APPLY**
Courts **h30**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

CORRUPTION

[corr12] Percent of firms believing the court system is fair, impartial and uncorrupted

Description

Percentage of firms that believe the court system is fair, impartial and uncorrupted.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable J.1

J.1	I am going to read some statements that describe the courts system and how it could affect business. For each statement, please tell me if you Strongly disagree, Tend to disagree, Tend to agree, or Strongly agree. **SHOW CARD 20**

	Strongly disagree	Tend to disagree	Tend to agree	Strongly agree	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
"The court system is fair, impartial and uncorrupted." **H7a**	1	2	3	4	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

The Enterprise Surveys include questions that provide a snapshot of jobs in the private sector. Specifically, four main indicators are constructed: the Share of Jobs across firm characteristics (such as size and sector), Jobs Expansion, Jobs Contraction, and Net Jobs Change. These indicators are based on Aga, Francis, and Rodriguez Meza (2015, Aga, Gemechu, David Francis, and Jorge Rodriguez-Meza. "SMEs, age, and jobs: A review of the literature, metrics, and evidence." *World Bank policy research working paper* 7493), which explores the types of firms that are significant employers and those that create or lose jobs at a faster rate. The authors employed methods similar to those of Haltiwanger, Jarmin, and Miranda (2013, Haltiwanger, John, Ron S. Jarmin, and Javier Miranda. "Who creates jobs? Small versus large versus young." Review of Economics and Statistics 95, no. 2: 347-361.), who used U.S. census data to identify common pitfalls in measuring the contributions of firms with various characteristics to overall job creation and destruction. Notably, unlike other indicators described in this document, the jobs indicators are aggregate measures and are not provided at the firm level. For this reason, standard errors are also not reported, as their estimation at the scale of the Enterprise Surveys is computationally prohibitive.

JOBS

[jobs1] Jobs share

Description

Jobs share measures the share of the aggregate stock of permanent, full-time workers across selected firm characteristics (e.g. small versus large, manufacturing versus services, female owned versus male owned, etc.). It shows how the total aggregate jobs in a country's private sector is distributed across these groups of firms.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs2] Firms that added jobs

Description

Firms that added jobs measures the share of firms that added permanent, full-time workers when comparing the latest fiscal year with the fiscal year two years earlier.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs3] Job expansion

Description

Job Expansion measures the annual rate of expansion of the aggregate stock of permanent, full-time workers. It only takes firms that, on net, added workers (indicator jobs2) and computes the yearly growth rate in the aggregate stock of permanent, full-time workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two basic variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs4] Share in job expansion

Description

Share in Job Expansion measures the share of the aggregate expansion of the stock of permanent, full-time workers across selected firm characteristics (e.g. small versus large, manufacturing versus services, female owned versus male owned, etc.).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two basic variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs5] Firms that reduced jobs

Description

Firms that reduced jobs measures the share of firms that reduced permanent, full-time workers when comparing the latest fiscal year with the fiscal year two years earlier.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two basic variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs6] Job contraction

Description

Job Contraction measures the annual rate of contraction of the aggregate stock of permanent, full-time workers. It only takes firms that, on net, reduced number of workers (indicator jobs5) and computes the yearly rate of contraction in the aggregate stock of permanent, full-time workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two basic variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs7] Share in job contraction

Description

Share in Job Contraction measures the share of the aggregate contraction of the stock of permanent, full-time workers across selected firm characteristics (e.g. small versus large, manufacturing versus services, female owned versus male owned, etc.).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two basic variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs8] Net job creation

Description

Net job creation Change measures the annual rate of net change in the aggregate stock of permanent, full-time workers. It takes all firms and computes net change of aggregate stock, i.e. expansion less contraction. Naturally, this indicator equals jobs expansion minus jobs contraction. Note that this indicator, unlike the Annual Employment Growth indicator (perf2) that is provided as part of the full set of firm-level ES indicators, measures aggregate growth of workers as opposed to the average firm-level growth.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two basic variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

JOBS

[jobs9] Share in net job creation

Description

Share in Net Job Creation measures the share of net change in the aggregate stock of permanent, full-time workers across selected firm characteristics (e.g. small versus large, manufacturing versus services, female owned versus male owned, etc.).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

Jobs expansion, contraction and net change are computed using two basic variables of the Enterprise Surveys: l1 and l2. Note that when considering the indicators of job expansion, contraction and net change disaggregated by size, firms are classified using the size category based on the mid-point between l1 and l2, that is (l1+l2)/2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[a20y],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Full-time workers work a full shift. Permanent workers are those that have worked for one year or more and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	**l1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Looking back, at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of fiscal year **[a20y-2]**	**l2**
ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS IN [a20y-2]	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 26, 2026	First added to the Enterprise Surveys country pages

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

The Enterprise Surveys provide indicators that describe information on the characteristics of the workforce employed in the non-agricultural private economy. The set of indicators presents the composition of the firm's workforce by type of contract and gender, the composition of the workforce classified into temporary and permanent workers, and reflects the participation of women in regular full-time employment. Labor regulations have a direct effect on the type of employment favored by firms and they may have a different impact by gender.

WORKFORCE

[wk1] [B-READY] Percent of firms offering formal training over last fiscal year

Description

Percentage of firms offering formal training programs for its permanent, full-time employees.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.10.

L.10	Over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment have formal training programs for its permanent, full-time employees?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION l30a***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION l30a***
		l10

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

[wk2] Average proportion of workers offered formal training over last fiscal year (%)*

Description

Percentage of permanent, full-time employees that have received formal training in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.3a, L.3b, L.11a, L.11b.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all paid employees that are contracted for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment contract and that work 8 or more hours per day) **(INTERVIEWER: include interviewee if applicable).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	**l1**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

L.3	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY**

	Number	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Production workers	**l3a**	**-9**
Non-production workers [e.g., managers, administration, sales]	**l3b**	**-9**

L.11	Referring to the training programs run over fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of permanent, full-time employees of the following categories received formal training? If easier please provide the total numbers (provide one or the other but not both)

	Percent		**NUMBER**	**IF NO EMPLOYEES IN A CATEGORY WERE TRAINED**	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Production full-time permanent employees trained	**l11a** %	**OR**	**l11a1**	**0**	**-9**
Non-production full-time permanent employees trained	**l11b** %		**l11b1**	**0**	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables l1, l3a, l3b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables l1, l3a, l3b

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk8] Average years of the top manager's experience working in the firm's sector

Description

Average years of experience of the top manager working in the sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.7.

B.7	How many years of experience working in this sector does the Top Manager have?

	Years
Manager's experience in sector	**b7**
Less than one year	**1**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk20] Percent of firms where the largest owner is also the top manager

Description

Percent of firms where the largest owner is also the top manager.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.3a.

B.3a	Is the largest owner also the Top Manager?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

b3a

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk14] Average number of workers

Description

Number of workers, including permanent and temporary workers. The number of temporary workers is adjusted for the number of months of their employment.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.6, and L.8.

L.1 At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers
(Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all employees that are employed for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work a full shift)
(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

L.6 How many full-time seasonal or temporary employees did this establishment employ during **[insert last complete fiscal year]**? (Full-time, temporary workers are all short-term (i.e. for less than a year) employees with no guarantee of renewal of employment and work full-time)

	Number	
Full-time seasonal or temporary workers employed last fiscal year	l6	
NO FULL-TIME SEASONAL OR TEMPORARY WORKERS	0	*GO TO QUESTION L.9b*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	*GO TO QUESTION L.9b*

L.8 What was the average length of employment of all full-time temporary employees in fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**?

	Months
Average length full-time seasonal or temporary employment last fiscal year, in months	l8
LESS THAN ONE MONTH	1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[wk21] Average number of permanent full-time equivalent workers

Description

Number of permanent full-time equivalent workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.6, L.8 and L.1a.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Permanent, full-time workers are defined as all workers that work for a term of one or more years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work a full shift. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.6	How many full-time seasonal or temporary workers did this establishment have during fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**? Full-time, seasonal or temporary workers are all short-term, that is for less than a year, workers with no guarantee of renewal of employment and work full-time.

	Number	
Full-time seasonal or temporary workers employed last fiscal year	l6	
NO FULL-TIME SEASONAL OR TEMPORARY WORKERS	**0**	***GO TO L.9b***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO L.9b***

L.8	What was the average length of employment of all full-time temporary workers in fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]?**

	Months
Average length full-time seasonal or temporary employment last fiscal year, in months	l8
LESS THAN ONE MONTH	**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.1a	At the end of fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, part-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Permanent, part-time workers are defined as all workers that work for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work for less than a full shift.

	Number
Part-time workers employed last fiscal year	l1a
NO PART-TIME WORKERS	**0**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes	
Indicator Updates	
July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk11] Average number of temporary workers

Description

Average number of temporary workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.6.

L.6	How many full-time seasonal or temporary employees did this establishment employ during **[insert last complete fiscal year]**? **(**Full-time, temporary workers are all short-term (i.e. for less than a year) employees with no guarantee of renewal of employment and work full-time)

	Number	
Full-time seasonal or temporary workers employed last fiscal year	l6	
NO FULL-TIME SEASONAL OR TEMPORARY WORKERS	**0**	***GO TO QUESTION L.9b***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION L.9b***

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable l6
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable l6

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk12] Average number of permanent full-time workers

Description

Average number of permanent, full time workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.1.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all paid employees that are contracted for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment contract and that work 8 or more hours per day) **(INTERVIEWER: include interviewee if applicable).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	**l1**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable l1
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable l1
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk3] Average number of permanent skilled production workers*

Description

Average number of skilled production workers in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.4a1, and L.4a2.

L.4	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent, full-time individuals working in this establishment were: **INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY**

	Number	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Workers in highly skilled production jobs, professionals whose tasks require extensive theoretical and technical knowledge	l4a1	-9
Workers in semi-skilled production jobs, technicians whose tasks require some level of mechanical or technical knowledge	l4a2	-9
Workers in unskilled production jobs, whose tasks involve no specialized knowledge		

Notes

The wording of these questions changed slightly to remain consistent with the ILO definitions. This change is effective as of the Bolivia 2017 ES.

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable l4a
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable l4a
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
June 26, 2017	Options for l4 were broken into additional categories.

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk4] Average number of permanent unskilled production workers*

Description

Average number of unskilled production workers in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.4b.

L.4	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent, full-time individuals working in this establishment were: **INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY**

	Number	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Workers in highly skilled production jobs, professionals whose tasks require extensive theoretical and technical knowledge		
Workers in semi-skilled production jobs, technicians whose tasks require some level of mechanical or technical knowledge		
Workers in unskilled production jobs, whose tasks involve no specialized knowledge	**l4b**	**-9**

Notes

The wording of these questions changed slightly to remain consistent with the ILO definitions. This change is effective as of the Bolivia 2017 ES.

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable l4b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable l4b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk6] Average number of permanent production workers*

Description

Average number of production workers in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.3a.

L.3	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY**

	Number	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Production workers	**l3a**	**-9**
Non-production workers [e.g., managers, administration, sales]		**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable l3a
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable l3a
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk7] Average number of permanent non-production workers*

Description

Average number of non-production workers in the manufacturing sector

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.3b.

L.3	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY**

	Number	**Don't know (spontaneous)**
Production workers		**-9**
Non-production workers [e.g., managers, administration, sales]	**l3b**	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variable l3b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variable l3b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk18] Average proportion of permanent workers, out of all workers

Description

The proportion of permanent workers out of all workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.6, and L.8. Note that it is calculated only if both the number of permanent and the number of temporary workers are available.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all employees that are employed for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work a full shift) **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.6	How many full-time seasonal or temporary employees did this establishment employ during **[insert last complete fiscal year]**? **(**Full-time, temporary workers are all short-term (i.e. for less than a year) employees with no guarantee of renewal of employment and work full-time)

	Number	
Full-time seasonal or temporary workers employed last fiscal year	l6	
NO FULL-TIME SEASONAL OR TEMPORARY WORKERS	**0**	***GO TO QUESTION L.9b***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION L.9b***

L.8	What was the average length of employment of all full-time temporary employees in fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**?

	Months
Average length full-time seasonal or temporary employment last fiscal year, in months	l8
LESS THAN ONE MONTH	**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[wk22] Average proportion of permanent workers, out of all permanent full-time equivalent workers

Description

Proportion of permanent workers, out of all permanent full-time equivalent workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.6, L.8 and L.1a. It is calculated by the ratio of l1 with wk21.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Permanent, full-time workers are defined as all workers that work for a term of one or more years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work a full shift. **INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIEWEE IF APPLICABLE**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers at the end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.6	How many full-time seasonal or temporary workers did this establishment have during fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]**? Full-time, seasonal or temporary workers are all short-term, that is for less than a year, workers with no guarantee of renewal of employment and work full-time.

	Number	
Full-time seasonal or temporary workers employed last fiscal year	l6	
NO FULL-TIME SEASONAL OR TEMPORARY WORKERS	**0**	***GO TO L.9b***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO L.9b***

L.8	What was the average length of employment of all full-time temporary workers in fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]?**

	Months
Average length full-time seasonal or temporary employment last fiscal year, in months	l8
LESS THAN ONE MONTH	**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.1a	At the end of fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, part-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all workers and managers. Permanent, part-time workers are defined as all workers that work for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work for less than a full shift.

	Number
Part-time workers employed last fiscal year	l1a
NO PART-TIME WORKERS	**0**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[wk17] Average proportion of temporary workers out of all workers

Description

The proportion of temporary workers out of all workers.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.6, and L8. Note that it is calculated only if both the number of permanent and the number of temporary workers are available.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all employees that are employed for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work a full shift) **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.6	How many full-time seasonal or temporary employees did this establishment employ during **[insert last complete fiscal year]**? **(**Full-time, temporary workers are all short-term (i.e. for less than a year) employees with no guarantee of renewal of employment and work full-time)

	Number	
Full-time seasonal or temporary workers employed last fiscal year	l6	
NO FULL-TIME SEASONAL OR TEMPORARY WORKERS	**0**	***GO TO QUESTION L.9b***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION L.9b***

L.8	What was the average length of employment of all full-time temporary employees in fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**?

	Months
Average length full-time seasonal or temporary employment last fiscal year, in months	l8
LESS THAN ONE MONTH	**1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk15] Average proportion of production workers, out of all permanent workers*

Description

Proportion of production workers out of all permanent workers in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.3a and L3b**.** Note that it is calculated only if both the number of production and the number of non-production workers are available.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all employees that are employed for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work a full shift) **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.3	Coming back to fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, at the end of the fiscal year, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **(INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY)**

	Number	**DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)**
Production workers	l3a	-9
Non-production workers [e.g., managers, administration, sales]	l3b	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk16] Average proportion of non-production workers out of all permanent workers*

Description

Proportion of non-production workers out of all permanent workers in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1, L.3a and L3b. Note that it is calculated only if both the number of production and the number of non-production workers are available.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all employees that are employed for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment and that work a full shift) **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.3	Coming back to fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, at the end of the fiscal year, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **(INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY)**

	Number	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Production workers	l3a	-9
Non-production workers [e.g., managers, administration, sales]	l3b	-9

Notes

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[wk19] Average proportion of skilled workers, out of all permanent production workers (%)*

Description

Proportion of skilled workers out of all production workers in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.3a, L.4a1, L.4a2 and L4b**.** Note that it is calculated only if both the number of skilled and the number of unskilled production workers are available.

L.3	Coming back to fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, at the end of the fiscal year, how many permanent, full-time individuals in this establishment were: **(INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY)**

	Number	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Production workers	l3a	-9
Non-production workers [e.g., managers, administration, sales]	l3b	-9

L.4	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent, full-time individuals working in this establishment were: **INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY**

	Number	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Workers in highly skilled production jobs, professionals whose tasks require extensive theoretical and technical knowledge	l4a1	-9
Workers in semi-skilled production jobs, technicians whose tasks require some level of mechanical or technical knowledge	l4a2	-9
Workers in unskilled production jobs, whose tasks involve no specialized knowledge	l4b	-9

Notes

The wording of these questions changed slightly to remain consistent with the ILO definitions. This change is effective as of the Bolivia 2017 ES.

Indicator Updates

August 7, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk23] Average proportion of permanent full time workers that completed high school

Description

Proportion of permanent full time workers that completed high school.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable l9b and l9b1.

L.9b	What percentage or how many of the full-time permanent individuals employed at the end of fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year]** completed secondary school? Please provide the percentage or number, not both.

	Percent
Percentage of full-time permanent workers who completed at least secondary school	**l9b** %
RESPONDENT PREFERS TO PROVIDE NUMBER OF WORKERS	**-5**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

	Number
Number of full-time permanent workers who completed at least secondary school	**l9b1**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
April 1, 2026	Code updated to include the ratio of l9b1 and l1 (total number of permanent full time workers) when no percentage value (l9b) was provided.

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk13] Average proportion of unskilled workers out of all permanent production workers (%)*

Description

The proportion of production workers who are unskilled. This indicator is calculated only for manufacturing firms.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.4a1, L.4a2, and L.4b. Note that it is calculated only if both the number of skilled and the number of unskilled production workers are available.

L.4	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, how many permanent, full-time individuals working in this establishment were: **INTERVIEWER: READ EACH CATEGORY**

	Number	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Workers in highly skilled production jobs, professionals whose tasks require extensive theoretical and technical knowledge	l4a1	-9
Workers in semi-skilled production jobs, technicians whose tasks require some level of mechanical or technical knowledge	l4a2	-9
Workers in unskilled production jobs, whose tasks involve no specialized knowledge	l4b	-9

Notes

The wording of these questions changed slightly to remain consistent with the ILO definitions. This change is effective as of the Bolivia 2017 ES.

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables l4a and l4b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables l4a and l4b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
J, 2017	Options for l4 were broken into additional categories.

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk24] [B-READY] Average weeks to dismiss a full-time permanent worker

Description

Average number of weeks it takes from the time the notice of dismissal was provided to the worker until the worker was removed from the establishment's payroll.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.35.

L.35	How many weeks did it typically take, from the time the notice of dismissal was provided to the worker until the worker was removed from the establishment's payroll? Please include all pre-notice requirements, notifications, and wait times.

	Weeks
Weeks to dismiss permanent, full-time worker	l35
ONE WEEK OR LESS	**1**
STILL IN PROCESS	**-6**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk25] [B-READY] Average weeks paid in severance

Description

Average of the typical severance payment for dismissed permanent, full-time workers, measured in weeks of salary, including pay and benefits but excluding unpaid salaries for time already worked.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.36.

L.36	How many weeks of salary was the typical severance payment for a dismissed permanent, full-time worker? Please include pay and benefits but exclude unpaid salaries for time already worked.

	Weeks
Weeks of salary paid for severance	l36
NO SEVERANCE WAS PAID	**0**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk26] [B-READY] Percent of firms involved in labor dispute over last 3 years

Description

Percentage of firms involved in labor dispute over last 3 years, including any formal disagreements over salary, benefits, health and safety, dismissal, or other labor-related issue. Labor disputes could involve individual workers or a group of workers (collective dispute).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.37.

L.37	Over the last three years, has this establishment been involved in any labor disputes? Labor disputes include any formal disagreements over salary, benefits, health and safety, dismissal, or other labor-related issue. Labor disputes could involve individual workers or a group of workers (collective dispute).

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO L.40***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO L.40***
		l37

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[wk27] [B-READY] Average months to resolve labor dispute

Description

Number of months it takes to resolve labor dispute.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.38.

Questionnaire 2023

L.38	How many months did it typically take from the moment the dispute arose until it got resolved, whether through an agreement, court decision, or other means?

	Months	
Time to resolve a labor dispute	l38	
ONE MONTH OR LESS	1	
NO DISPUTE HAS BEEN RESOLVED	-7	*GO TO L.40*
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	

Questionnaire 2024

L.38	How many months did it typically take from the moment the dispute arose until it got resolved, whether through an agreement, court decision, or other means?

	Months		Days
Time to resolve a labor dispute	l38a		
LESS THAN ONE MONTH	0	*IF LESS THAN 1 MONTH*	l38b
NO DISPUTE HAS BEEN RESOLVED	-7	*GO TO L.40*	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9		

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	In cases where l38a is less than a month and answer in terms of days (l38b) is "don't know", 1 month is assigned (instead of excluding from calculations). This preserves backward consistency.

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk9] Percent of firms identifying labor regulations as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying labor regulations as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.30a.

L.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree are **Labor Regulations** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment?

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Labor regulations **l30a**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk28] [B-READY] Average perceptions index of labor regulations as a constraint

Description

Perceptions index of labor regulations as a constraint on a scale of 0 to 100. For this indicator, 0 is assigned for "no obstacle", 25 for "minor" obstacle, 50 for "moderate" obstacle, 75 for "major" obstacle, and 100 for "very severe" obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.30a.

L.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree are each of the following an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **INTERVIEWER: READ OUT OPTIONS** **SHOW CARD 29**

						(SPONTANEOUS)	
	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	DON'T KNOW	DOES NOT APPLY
Labor regulations l30a	0	1	2	3	4	-9	-7

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released
September 22, 2025	Scale modified for consistency with other perception indicators

Back to List of Indicators

WORKFORCE

[wk10] Percent of firms identifying an inadequately educated workforce as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying labor skill level as a "major" or "very severe" constraint. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: l30b==3 or 4 is coded as 100; l30b ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable L.30b.

L.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **an Inadequately Educated Workforce** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 22**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Inadequately educated workforce **l30b**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

The Enterprise Surveys provide indicators that describe several dimensions of management practices. These indicators measure the extent to which firms implement better practices such as taking long-term actions to fix and avoid problems in production or service-delivery; number, time-horizon, and other features of production of service-provision targets; use of bonuses or promotion to reward better performance, and demotion to limit under-performance. A subset of survey questions developed by Bloom and Van Reenen (2007, Bloom, Nicholas, and John Van Reenen. "Measuring and explaining management practices across firms and countries." The quarterly journal of Economics 122, no. 4 (2007): 1351-1408) were adapted and implemented as part of the Enterprise Surveys across countries. An important change in the survey methodology was avoiding double-barrelled questions by adding filters. Double-barrelled questions can lead to over reporting if the topic being measured is prone to desirability bias; better management practices are arguably more desirable for good managers. For example, the number of production or service-provision targets is asked in two parts in the Enterprise Surveys: the firms are first asked if they have such targets, and those that say Yes are then asked a follow-up question on the number of such targets. This is methodologically different from asking about this in one question, with “No target” being a response category among the range of targets. The Enterprise Surveys team is documenting the important repercussion this methodological change has on the estimates of management practices in an upcoming research paper.

For the Enterprise Surveys indicators on management practices, the response categories were mapped into the values of the indicator following the coding conventions given in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" American Economic Review 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In this mapping, the responses that suggest the most structured management practice are normalized to 100, and the ones suggesting the least structured are normalized to zero. Bloom et al. (2019) define more structured management practices as those that are more specific, formal, frequent or explicit. It is thus expected that higher levels of these indicators mean better management practices. Note that the management practices indicators are calculated for firms with at least 20 employees, and uninformative responses (i.e., “don’t know”) are treated as missing.

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt1] Average management practices index for medium and large firms

Description

Composite index that combines information from eight management practices indicators that are described below (please see mgmt2 through mgmt9 starting on the next page). It is calculated as follows:

$$mgmt1_i = \frac{\sum_{j=2}^{9} mgmtj_i}{8}$$

where $mgmtj_i = [0,100]$ is management practice j (2 through 9) by business i, averaged over all 8 components. Observations for which all 8 components are available are used. Due to this structure, mgmt1 varies between 0 and 100. This composite index and all its 8 components are calculated only for establishments with 20 or more employees (i.e., only medium and large firms)

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This composite indicator is created from the following variables: R.1, R.2, R.3, R.4, R.5, R.6, R.7, R.8, R.9, R.10, R.11.

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released
June 26, 2023	Correction to handle r10 = -7 as described, instead of as missing

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt2] Average score of medium and large firms on action when a problem arose

Description

What best describes what happens at your firm when a problem in the production process arises? Examples of problems include: finding a quality defect in a service, product, or a piece of equipment breaks down. To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r1==3 is coded as 100; r1==2 is coded as 66.67; r1==1 is coded as 33.33; r1==4 is coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable R.1.

R.1	**ASK IF MANUFACTURING** Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** what best describes what happened at this establishment when a problem in the production process arose? **ASK IF SERVICES** Over fiscal year **[Insert last complete fiscal year],** What best describes what happened at this establishment when a problem in the provision of services arose?

INTERVIEWER: SELECT "DOES NOT APPLY" (-7) IF THERE WERE NO PROBLEMS IN THE PRODUCTION PROCESS IN THE LAST COMPLETE FISCAL YEAR

We fixed it but did not take further action	1
We fixed it and took action to make sure it did not happen again	2
We fixed it and took action to make sure that it did not happen again, and had a continuous improvement process to anticipate problems like these in advance	3
No action was taken	4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

r1

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt3] Average score of medium and large firms on number of performance indicators monitored

Description

Over the last complete fiscal year, how many key performance indicators are monitored in this firm? Examples of key performance indicators include: metrics on service quality, customer satisfaction, production, cost, waste, quality, inventory, and absenteeism. To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r3==3 is coded as 100; r3==2 is coded as 66.67; r3==1 is coded as 33.33; r2==2 is coded as 0. As mentioned in the introduction, this is an example of when a double-barrelled survey question from Bloom et al. (2019) was split in two, by adding a filer. Repercussions of this methodological change is being investigated by the Enterprise Surveys team in an upcoming working paper.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from variables R.2 and R.3.

R.2	Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment monitor any performance indicators?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
	r2

R.3	How many performance indicators were monitored?

1-2 indicators	1
3-9 indicators	2
10 or more indicators	3
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
	r3

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt4] Average score of medium and large firms on time focus of production/service provision targets

Description

What best describes the time frame of operational targets at this firm? Examples of operational targets include: customer satisfaction, wait-times, production, quality, efficiency, on-time delivery. To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r5==3 is coded as 1; r5==2 is coded as 66.67; r5==1 is coded as 33.33; r4==2 is coded as 0. As mentioned in the introduction, this is another example of when a double-barrelled survey question from Bloom et al. (2019) was split in two, by adding a filer (R.4). Repercussions of this methodological change is being investigated by the Enterprise Surveys team in an upcoming working paper.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from variables R.4 and R.5.

R.4	**ASK IF MANUFACTURING** Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment have production targets? Examples of production targets are volume, quality, efficiency, waste, or on-time delivery. **ASK IF SERVICES** Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment have service provision targets? Examples of production targets are sales, customer satisfaction, efficiency, waste, or on-time delivery.

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

r4

R.5	**ASK IF MANUFACTURING** What best describes the time frame of those production targets? **ASK IF SERVICES** What best describes the time frame of those service provision targets?

Main focus was on short term, less than one year	1
Main focus was on long term, one year or more	2
Combination of short-term and long-term targets	3
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

r5

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[mgmt5] Average score of medium and large firms on achievability of production/service provision targets

Description

How easy or difficult is it in your firm for people to typically achieve their operational targets? To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r6==4 is coded as 1; r6==3 is coded as 0.75; r6==2 is coded as 0.5; r6==5 and r6==6 are coded as 0.25; r6==1 and r4==2 are coded as 0. Notice that 'Targets not achieved' (r6=6) and 'Only achieved with extraordinary effort' (r6=5) were coded together as 0.25; and 'Achieved without much effort' (r6==1) and 'No targets' (r4=2) were coded together as 0. As mentioned above, this is another example of when a double-barreled survey question from Bloom et al. (2019) was split in two, by adding a filer (R.4). Repercussions of this methodological change is being investigated by the Enterprise Surveys team in an upcoming working paper.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from variables R.4 and R.6.

R.4	**ASK IF MANUFACTURING** Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment have production targets? Examples of production targets are volume, quality, efficiency, waste, or on-time delivery. **ASK IF SERVICES** Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment have service provision targets? Examples of production targets are sales, customer satisfaction, efficiency, waste, or on-time delivery.

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

r4

R.6	**ASK IF MANUFACTURING** How easy or difficult was it for this establishment to achieve those production targets overall? **ASK IF SERVICES** How easy or difficult was it for this establishment to achieve those service provision targets overall?

Achieved without much effort	1
Achieved with some effort	2
Achieved with normal amount of effort	3
Achieved with more than normal effort	4
Only achieved with extraordinary effort	5
Targets not achieved	6
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

r6

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt6] Average score of medium and large firms on knowledge of production/service provision targets

Description

Who was aware of the operational targets at this firm? To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r7==4 is coded as 1; r7==3 is coded as 0.67; r7==2 is coded as 0.33; r7==1 and r4==2 are coded as 0. Notice that 'Only senior managers' and 'No targets' (r4=2) were coded together as 0. As mentioned above, this is another example of when a double-barrelled survey question from Bloom et al. (2019) was split in two, by adding a filer (R.4). Repercussions of this methodological change is being investigated by the Enterprise Surveys team in an upcoming working paper.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from variables R.4 and R.7.

R.4	**ASK IF MANUFACTURING** Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment have production targets? Examples of production targets are volume, quality, efficiency, waste, or on-time delivery. **ASK IF SERVICES** Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment have service provision targets? Examples of production targets are sales, customer satisfaction, efficiency, waste, or on-time delivery.

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
	r4

R.7	**ASK IF MANUFACTURING** Who was aware of the production targets at this establishment? **ASK IF SERVICES** Who was aware of the service provision targets at this establishment?

Only senior managers	1
Most managers and some production workers	2
Most managers and most production workers	3
All managers and most production workers	4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
	r7

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt7] Average score of medium and large firms on basis of managers' performance bonuses

Description

Over the last completed fiscal year, what were managers' performance bonuses usually based on in this firm? To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r9==1 is coded as 1; r9==2 is coded as 0.75; r9==3 is coded as 0.5; r9==4 is coded as 0.25; r8==2 is coded as 0. As mentioned in the introduction, this is another example of when a double-barrelled survey question from Bloom et al. (2019) was split in two, by adding a filer (R.8). Repercussions of this methodological change is being investigated by the Enterprise Surveys team in an upcoming working paper.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from variables R.8 and R.9.

R.8	Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], did this establishment have performance bonuses for managers?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

r8

R.9	What were those managers' performance bonuses mostly based on?

Their own performance	1
Their team's performance	2
The establishment's performance	3
The firm's performance	4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

r9

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt8] Average score of medium and large firms on extent to which non-managers are promoted based on performance

Description

What is the primary way non-managers are promoted in this firm? To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r10==1 is coded as 1; r10==2 is coded as 0.67; r10==3 is coded as 0.33; r10==4 and r10==-7 are coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable R.10.

R.10	Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], what was the primary way non-managers were promoted at this establishment?

INTERVIEWER: SELECT "DOES NOT APPLY" (-7) IF THERE WERE NO PROMOTIONS OF NON-MANAGERS IN THE LAST COMPLETE FISCAL YEAR

Based solely on performance and ability	1
Based partly on performance and ability, and partly on other factors (for example, tenure or family connections)	2
Based mainly on factors other than performance and ability (for example, tenure or family connections)	3
Non-managers are not normally promoted	4
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

r10

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released
June 26, 2023	Correction to handle r10 = -7 as described, instead of as missing

Back to List of Indicators

MANAGEMENT PRACTICES

[mgmt9] Average score of medium and large firms on extent to which under-performing non-managers are reassigned or dismissed

Description

Over the last fiscal year, within what timeframe was an under-performing non-manager reassigned or dismissed? To map between response categories and values of the indicator, the coding conventions are used as in the Table A2 in Bloom, Nicholas, Erik Brynjolfsson, Lucia Foster, Ron Jarmin, Megha Patnaik, Itay Saporta-Eksten, and John Van Reenen. "What drives differences in management practices?" *American Economic Review* 109, no. 5 (2019): 1648-1683. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: r11==1 is coded as 1; r11==2 is coded as 0.5; r11==3 is coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable R.11.

R.11	Over fiscal year [Insert last complete fiscal year], when was an under-performing non-manager reassigned or dismissed?

Within 6 months of identifying under-performance	1
After 6 months of identifying under-performance	2
Rarely or never	3
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

r11

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 15, 2023	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

The Enterprise Surveys provide indicators that describe several dimensions of technology use and innovation. These indicators measure the extent to which firms invest in obtaining recognized certificates of production and accounting practices. Obtaining international quality certifications may support creating more efficient or effective operations and improve employee's motivation, awareness, and morale. They also provide a sign of high quality that may help reduce waste and increase productivity. Additionally, these indicators demonstrate the use of information and communications technologies (ICT) in business transactions. ICT, such as the Internet, are important tools for all firms because they provide even the smallest of enterprises with the ability to reach national and international markets at lower cost.

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t7] Percent of firms that introduced a new product/service over last 3 years

Description

Percentage of firms that introduced new or significantly improved products or services over the last three years.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable H.1

H.1	During the last three years, has this establishment introduced new or significantly improved products or services?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

h1

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t7_ml] [B-READY] Percent of medium and large firms that introduced a new product/service over last 3 years

Description

Percentage of medium and large firms that introduced new or significantly improved products or services over the last three years.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable H.1

H.1	During the last three years, has this establishment introduced new or significantly improved products or services?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

h1

Notes

Indicator Updates

September 22, 2025	First released

Back to List of Indicators

[t8] Percent of firms whose new product/service is also new to the main market

Description

Percentage of firms that introduced new or significantly improved products or services over the last three years that were also new for the firms' main market.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables H.1 and H.2

H.1	During the last three years, has this establishment introduced new or significantly improved products or services?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION H.5***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION H.5***
		h1

H.2	Were any of the new or significantly improved products or services also new for the establishment's main market?

Yes	1	
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		h2

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t9] Percent of firms that introduced a process innovation over last 3 years

Description

Percentage of firms that introduced any new or significantly improved process.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable H.5

H.5	During the last three years, has this establishment introduced any new or significantly improved process? These include: methods of manufacturing products or offering services; logistics, delivery, or distribution methods for inputs, products, or services; or supporting activities for processes?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

h5

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t9_ml] [B-READY] Percent of medium and large firms that introduced a process innovation over last 3 years

Description

Percentage of medium and large firms that introduced any new or significantly improved process.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable H.5

H.5	During the last three years, has this establishment introduced any new or significantly improved process? These include: methods of manufacturing products or offering services; logistics, delivery, or distribution methods for inputs, products, or services; or supporting activities for processes?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

h5

Notes

Indicator Updates

September 22, 2025	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t10] [B-READY] Percent of medium and large firms that spend on R&D in the last fiscal years

Description

Percentage of medium and large firms that spent on formal research and development activities during the last fiscal year.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable H.8

H.8	During last fiscal year, did this establishment spend on formal research and development activities, either in-house or contracted with other companies, excluding market research surveys?

Yes	1
No	2
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

h8

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released
January 30, 2023	The indicator is restricted to establishments with 20 or more employees

Back to List of Indicators

[t11] Percent of medium and large firms that introduced a new product/service and process over last 3 years, and spent on R&D over last fiscal year

Description

Percentage of medium and large firms that introduced a new product/service and process over last 3 years, and spent on R&D over last fiscal year (excluding small firms).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable H.1, H.5 and H.8.

H.1	During the last three years, has this establishment introduced new or improved products or services?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO H.5***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO H.5***
		h1

H.5	During the last three years, has this establishment introduced any new or improved process? These include: methods of manufacturing products or offering services; logistics, delivery, or distribution methods for inputs, products, or services; or supporting activities for processes?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO H.8***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO H.8***
		h5

H.8	During fiscal year [**Insert last complete fiscal year**], did this establishment spend on research and development activities, either in-house or contracted with other companies, excluding market research surveys?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO F.1***
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	***GO TO F.1***
		h8

Notes

Indicator Updates

July 5, 2024	First released

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t1] [B-READY] Percent of firms with an internationally-recognized quality certification

Description

Percentage of firms that have an internationally-recognized quality certification, i.e. ISO 9000, 9002 or 14000.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.8

B.8	Does this establishment have an internationally-recognized quality certification? **(INTERVIEWER: if there is need for clarification, some examples are: ISO 9000 or 14000, or HAPC)**

Yes	1
No	2
Still in process	**-6**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

b8

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t4] Percent of firms using technology licensed from foreign companies*

Description

Percentage of firms using technology licensed from foreign companies in the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable E.6.

E.6	Does this establishment at present use technology licensed from a foreign-owned company, excluding office software?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
	e6

Notes

Indicator Updates

Apr.29.2014	Manufacturing only

Back to List of Indicators

INNOVATION AND TECHNOLOGY

[t5] Percent of firms having their own web site

Description

Percentage of firms using website for business related activities, i.e. sales, product promotion etc.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable C.22b

C.22b	At the present time, does this establishment use its own website?

Yes	1
No	2
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
	c22b

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

In addition to collecting information on the business environment, Enterprise Surveys collect information on the performance of the firms interviewed. Firms are asked about their annual sales figures and number of permanent full-time employees at the end of the last fiscal year as well as three fiscal years ago.

Indicators show the performance of firms by growth in sales, employment, and labor productivity. All sales data have been converted to 2009 U.S. dollars for global comparability. While different countries will have different growth patterns, comparing performance within a country by firm size or industry or other firm subgroups can yield interesting insights for policymakers and researchers.

Furthermore, Enterprise Surveys collect information on the characteristics of the firms interviewed. Given that the surveys are representative of the corresponding Enterprise Surveys universe, the data collected provides a description of the representative private firm in the country and an estimate of how some of the attributes of the average firm are distributed across the population of firms.

Indicators show the distribution of firms according to their age measured by the number of years they have been in operation. The effect the business environment can have on the private sector may depend on firms' experience and longevity. Seasoned firms and young firms may differ in their ability to successfully navigate the business environment.

Indicators also quantify the level of female participation in management and firm ownership. These indicators can help assess whether gender influences the level of exposure of the firm to external factors, such as corruption, access to finance, and technology.

Finally, indicators show the participation of the domestic private sector, the government, the foreign sector and other sectors in the ownership of the typical firm. The distribution provides insight into their levels of equity in the private sector of the economy.

FIRM PROFILE

[perf1] Average real annual sales growth (%)

Description

Real annual sales growth is measured as a percentage change in sales between the last completed fiscal year and a previous period. All sales values are deflated to 2009 using each country's GDP deflators.[2] The formula is:

$$\left(\frac{1}{t}\right) * \frac{d2' - n3'}{(d2' + n3')/2} * (100)$$

where *t* is the number of years between the current and previous periods, and *d2'* and *n3'* are deflated values of *d2* and *n3* variables. Note that the GDP deflators are weighted by the closing month of each firms' fiscal year. For example, if a firm's last complete fiscal year spans July 2015 through June 2016, then deflator used for d2 is: $\frac{6}{12} \cdot$ deflator for year 2015 + $\frac{6}{12} \cdot$ deflator for year 2016.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables D.2 and N.3.

D.2	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what were this establishment's total annual sales for **ALL** products and services?

	LCUs
Last complete fiscal year's total sales	**d2**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
PLEASE ALSO WRITE OUT THE NUMBER (i.e. 50,000 as Fifty Thousand)	
	d2x

N.3	In fiscal year **[insert three complete fiscal years ago],** three fiscal years ago, what were total annual sales for this establishment?

	LCUs
Total annual sales three years ago	**n3**
IF ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS THREE YEARS AGO	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 3, 2012	Added to ES Indicators
December 15, 2016	Methodology Change: see Descriptions of Indicator Updates at the end of this document
September 11, 2017	Methodology Change: see Descriptions of Indicator Updates at the end of this document

Back to List of Indicators

[2] GDP deflators are from the World Development Indicators, series NY.GDP.DEFL.ZS

FIRM PROFILE

[perf2] Average annual employment growth (%)

Description

Annualized growth of permanent full-time workers expressed as a percentage. Annual employment growth is the change in full-time employment reported in the current fiscal year from a previous period. For most countries the difference between the two fiscal year periods is two years. However, for some countries the interval is three years. Hence, an annualized measure is used. The formula is

$$\left(\frac{1}{t}\right) * \frac{l1 - l2}{(l1 + l2)/2} * (100)$$

where t is the number of years between the current and previous periods.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables L.1 and L.2.

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all paid employees that are contracted for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment contract and that work a full shift) **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Three fiscal years ago, at the end of fiscal year **[insert three complete fiscal years ago],** how many permanent, full-time individuals work in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers three fiscal years ago	l2
IF ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS THREE YEARS AGO	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

January 3, 2012	Added to ES Indicators

Back to List of Indicators

[perf3] Average real annual labor productivity growth (%)

Description

Annual labor productivity growth is measured by a percentage change in labor productivity between the last completed fiscal year and a previous period, where labor productivity is sales divided by the number of full-time permanent workers. All sales values are deflated to 2009 using each country's GDP deflators.[3] The formula is:

$$\left(\frac{1}{t}\right) * \frac{\left(\frac{d2'}{l1}\right) - \left(\frac{n3'}{l2}\right)}{\left\{\left(\frac{d2'}{l1}\right) + \left(\frac{n3'}{l2}\right)\right\}/2} * (100)$$

where *t* is the number of years between the current and previous periods, *l1* and *l2* are the number of full-time permanent workers, and *d2'* and *n3'* are deflated values of *d2* and *n3* variables. Note that the GDP deflators are weighted by the closing month of each firms' fiscal year. For example, if a firm's last complete fiscal year spans July 2015 through June 2016, then deflator used for d2 is: $\frac{6}{12} \cdot$ deflator for year 2015 + $\frac{6}{12} \cdot$ deflator for year 2016.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables D.2, N.3, L.1, and L.2.

D.2	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what were this establishment's total annual sales for **ALL** products and services?

	LCUs
Last complete fiscal year's total sales	**d2**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
PLEASE ALSO WRITE OUT THE NUMBER (i.e. 50,000 as Fifty Thousand)	
	d2x

N.3	In fiscal year **[insert three complete fiscal years ago],** three fiscal years ago, what were total annual sales for this establishment?

	LCUs
Total annual sales three years ago	**n3**
IF ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS THREE YEARS AGO	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

[3] GDP deflators are from the World Development Indicators, series NY.GDP.DEFL.ZS

L.1	At the end of fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year],** how many permanent, full-time individuals worked in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers (Permanent, full-time employees are defined as all paid employees that are contracted for a term of one or more fiscal years and/or have a guaranteed renewal of their employment contract and that work a full shift) **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE).**

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers end of last fiscal year	l1
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

L.2	Three fiscal years ago, at the end of fiscal year **[insert three complete fiscal years ago],** how many permanent, full-time individuals work in this establishment? Please include all employees and managers **(INTERVIEWER: INCLUDE INTERVIWEE IF APPLICABLE**).

	Number
Permanent, full-time workers three fiscal years ago	l2
IF ESTABLISHMENT WAS NOT IN BUSINESS THREE YEARS AGO	**-7**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates	
January 3, 2012	Added to ES Indicators
December 15, 2016	Methodology Change: see Descriptions of Indicator Updates at the end of this document
September 11, 2017	Methodology Change: see Descriptions of Indicator Updates at the end of this document

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[perf4] Percent of firms buying fixed assets

Description

Percent of firms buying fixed assets such as machinery, equipment, land or buildings.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable K.4.

K.4	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment purchase any new or used fixed assets, such as machinery, vehicles, equipment, land or buildings?

Yes	1	
No	2	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**	
		k4

Notes

Indicator Updates

Nov.11.2014	New indicator added

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[t3] Average capacity utilization (%)*

Description

Capacity utilization, defined as current output as a percentage of the maximum output possible if using all physical capital available. It is defined only for the manufacturing sector.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable F.1.

F.1	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what was this establishment's output produced as a proportion of the maximum output possible if using all the resources available (capacity utilization)?

	Percent
Capacity utilization	**f1** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car1] Average age of the establishment (years)

Description

Age of the firm based on the year in which the firm began operations.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.5.

B.5	In what year did this establishment begin operations in this country?

	Year
Year establishment began operations	**b5**

INTERVIEWER: PROVIDE FOUR DIGITS FOR YEAR

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 30, 2009	Adjustment: car1 takes only values less than 100
February 28, 2011	Adjustment: car1 can take on any values thus reversing the limitation imposed June 30, 2009. However, car1 is now subject to outliers removal whereby the variable is log-transformed and then trimmed at plus and minus 3 standard deviations from the mean for each survey.
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car7] Percent of firms with at least 10% of foreign ownership

Description

Percentage of firms that have at least 10% owned by private foreign individuals, companies or organizations.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.2b

B.2	What percentage of this firm is owned by each of the following: **SHOW CARD 2**

	Percent	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Private domestic individuals, companies or organizations		-9
Private foreign individuals, companies or organizations	b2b %	-9
Government or State		-9
Other		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car8] Percent of firms with at least 10% of government/state ownership

Description

Percentage of firms where the government or state has at least a 10% share in ownership of the firm but not fully owned by government (that is, excluding b2c=100%).

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable B.2c

B.2	What percentage of this firm is owned by each of the following: **SHOW CARD 2**

	Percent	DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)
Private domestic individuals, companies or organizations		-9
Private foreign individuals, companies or organizations		-9
Government or State	b2c %	-9
Other		-9
	100%	

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%
(UNLESS RESPONDENT DOES NOT KNOW)

Notes

Indicator Updates

June 26, 2017	First released

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car2] Average proportion of private domestic ownership in a firm (%)

Description

Percentage of the firm owned by domestic individuals, companies or organizations.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.2a

B.2	What percent of this firm is owned by each of the following: **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 2**

	Percent
a. Private domestic individuals, companies or organizations	**b2a** %
b. Private foreign individuals, companies or organizations	
c. Government/State	
d. Other	
	100%

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car3] Average proportion of private foreign ownership in a firm (%)

Description

Percentage of the firm owned by foreign individuals, companies or organizations.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.2b.

B.2	What percent of this firm is owned by each of the following: **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 2**

	Percent
a. Private domestic individuals, companies or organizations	
b. Private foreign individuals, companies or organizations	**b2b** %
c. Government/State	
d. Other	
	100%

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car4] Average proportion of government/state ownership in a firm (%)

Description

Percentage of the firm owned by the government or state.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.2c.

B.2	What percent of this firm is owned by each of the following: **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 2**

	Percent
a. Private domestic individuals, companies or organizations	
b. Private foreign individuals, companies or organizations	
c. Government/State	**b2c** %
d. Other	
	100%

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car5] Average proportion of other ownership in a firm (%)

Description

Percentage of the firm owned by other interests.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.2d.

B.2	What percent of this firm is owned by each of the following: **INTERVIEWER: SHOW CARD 2**

	Percent
a. Private domestic individuals, companies or organizations	
b. Private foreign individuals, companies or organizations	
c. Government/State	
d. Other	**b2d** %
	100%

INTERVIEWER: CHECK THAT TOTAL SUMS TO 100%

Notes

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys
May 29, 2014	This indicator was out of date and had been removed from ES website

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[car6] Average proportion of a firm held by the largest owner(s) (%)

Description

Percentage held by largest owner or owners.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.3.

B.3	What percent of this firm does the largest owner or owner(s) own?

	Percent
Percent held by largest owner	**b3** %

Notes

Indicator Updates

February 28, 2011	Please also note that for all countries, b3 was imputed with 100% when firm's legal status is Sole proprietorship and b3 was missing due to a skip pattern. This is a significant change as in many surveys answering positively to being a Sole Proprietorship caused a skip of question b3.
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform3] Percent of firms with legal status of Sole Proprietorship

Description

Percent of firms with legal status of Sole Proprietorship

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2
Sole proprietorship	3
Partnership	4
Limited partnership	5
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) ___b1x___	6
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform] Legal status

Description

Legal status of firms. 1 is assigned for "shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market", 2 for "shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately", 3 for "sole proprietorship", 4 for "partnership", 5 for "limited partnership".

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1	
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2	
Sole proprietorship	3	
Partnership	4	
Limited partnership	5	
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) __b1x__	6	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	
		b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform_max] Most common legal form

Description

The most common legal form of firms.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2
Sole proprietorship	3
Partnership	4
Limited partnership	5
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) ___b1x___	6
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform1] Percent of firms with legal status of publicly listed company

Description

Percentage of firms with legal status of publicly listed company

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2
Sole proprietorship	3
Partnership	4
Limited partnership	5
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) ___b1x___	6
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform2] Percent of firms with legal status of shareholding company with non-traded or privately traded shares

Description

Percent of firms with legal status of shareholding company with non-traded or privately traded shares

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1	
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2	
Sole proprietorship	3	
Partnership	4	
Limited partnership	5	
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) ___b1x___	6	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	
		b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform4] Percent of firms with legal status of Partnership

Description

Percent of firms with legal status of Partnership

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2
Sole proprietorship	3
Partnership	4
Limited partnership	5
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) ___b1x___	6
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform5] Percent of firms with legal status of Limited Partnership

Description

Percent of firms with legal status of Limited Partnership

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1	
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2	
Sole proprietorship	3	
Partnership	4	
Limited partnership	5	
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) ___b1x___	6	
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9	
		b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

FIRM PROFILE

[lform6] Legal status - Other

Description

Percent of firms with legal status of other.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables B.1.

B.1	What is this firm's current legal status? SHOW CARD 1

Shareholding company with shares trade in the stock market	1
Shareholding company with non-traded shares or shares traded privately	2
Sole proprietorship	3
Partnership	4
Limited partnership	5
OTHER (SPONTANEOUS–SPECIFY) ___b1x___	6
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	-9

b1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

The Enterprise Surveys collect mostly quantitative and factual information (the actual day-to-day experiences) from business owners and managers on a range of topics regarding the business environment. Towards the end of the survey interview, there is an opinion-based question asked to the survey respondent that pulls together the various survey topics. Firms are asked to consider which element (out of a list of 15) is the Biggest Obstacle to their establishment. The following group of indicators summarizes how many firms chose each of the various 15 elements. These indicators can aid policymakers in setting priorities when creating programs and policies aimed at improving the business-enabling environment.

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst1] Percent of firms choosing access to finance as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider access to finance to be the Biggest Obstacle

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card [**insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst2] Percent of firms choosing access to land as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider access to land to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst3] Percent of firms choosing business licensing and permits as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider business licensing and permits to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst4] Percent of firms choosing corruption as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider corruption to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst5] Percent of firms choosing courts as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider courts to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst6] Percent of firms choosing crime, theft and disorder as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider crime, theft and disorder to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst7] Percent of firms choosing customs and trade regulations as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider customs and trade regulations to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card [**insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst8] Percent of firms choosing electricity as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider electricity to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst9] Percent of firms choosing inadequately educated workforce as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider an inadequately educated workforce to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst10] Percent of firms choosing labor regulations as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider labor regulations to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst11] Percent of firms choosing political instability as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider political instability to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst12] Percent of firms choosing practices of the informal sector as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider practices of competitors in the informal sector to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card [**insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst13] Percent of firms choosing tax administration as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider the tax administration to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card [**insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst14] Percent of firms choosing tax rates as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider tax rates to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

BIGGEST OBSTACLE

[obst15] Percent of firms choosing transportation as their biggest obstacle

Description

Percentage of establishments that consider transport to be the Biggest Obstacle.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables M.1.

M.1	By looking at card **[insert card number]** can you tell me which of the elements of the business environment included in the list, if any, currently represents the biggest obstacle faced by this establishment **SHOW CARD 25** **INTERVIEWER: DO NOT READ OUT**

1-Access to finance
2-Access to land
3-Business licensing and permits
4-Corruption
5-Courts
6-Crime, theft and disorder
7-Customs and trade regulations
8-Electricity
9-Inadequately educated workforce
10-Labor regulations
11-Political instability
12-Practices of competitors in the informal sector
13-Tax administration
14-Tax rates
15-Transport

Biggest obstacle	**m1a**
DON'T KNOW (SPONTANEOUS)	**-9**
DOES NOT APPLY (SPONTANEOUS)	**-7**

Rotation (option 1, 2 or 3)	**m1d**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

CRIME

Crime imposes costs on firms when they are forced to divert resources from productive uses to cover security costs. Both foreign and domestic investors perceive crime as an indication of social instability, and crime drives up the cost of doing business. Also, commercial disputes between firms and their clients occur regularly while doing business. Resolving these disputes can be challenging when legal institutions are weak or nonexistent.

The Enterprise Surveys capture key dimensions of the effect of crime on firm sales, the extent to which entrepreneurs identify courts as fair and more. For example, the set of indicators measures the direct costs of security incurred by firms as well as their direct losses due to crime. These resources represent an opportunity cost since they could have been invested in productive activities. Another indicator (Perceptions about the Courts) shows the share of firms that recognize the functioning of the courts as being fair, impartial, and uncorrupted.

CRIME

[crime1] Percent of firms paying for security

Description

Percentage of firms paying for security, for example equipment, personnel, or professional security services.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable I.1.

I.1	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment pay for security, for example equipment, personnel, or professional security services?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION I.3***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION I.3***
		i1

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

CRIME

[crime10] Percent of firms experiencing losses due to theft and vandalism

Description

Percent of firms experiencing losses due to theft, robbery, vandalism or arson that occurred on the establishment's premises

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables I.3.

I.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience losses as a result of theft, robbery, vandalism or arson?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION I.30***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION I.30***
		i3

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicators

CRIME

[crime3] Average losses due to theft and vandalism against the firm (% of annual sales)

Description

Estimated losses as a result of theft, robbery, vandalism or arson that occurred on establishment's premises calculated as a percentage of annual sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables I.3 and I.4**.** If the respondent answered I4b, then the value is divided by annual sales (D2).

I.3	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment experience losses as a result of theft, robbery, vandalism or arson?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION I.30***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION I.30***
		i3

I.4	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what were the estimated losses as a result of theft, robbery, vandalism or arson that occurred on this establishment's premises either as a percentage of total annual sales or as total annual losses?

	Percent
Losses as percentage of total annual sales	**i4a** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

PROVIDE EITHER ONE OR THE OTHER, NOT BOTH

	LCUs
Total annual value of losses	**i4b**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, i4b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, i4a, i4b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

CRIME

[crime3_c] If there were losses, average losses due to theft and vandalism (% of annual sales)

Description

If there were losses, estimated losses as a result of theft, robbery, vandalism or arson that occurred on establishment's premises calculated as a percentage of annual sales.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable I.4. If the respondent answered I4b, then the value is divided by annual sales (D2).

I.4	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what were the estimated losses as a result of theft, robbery, vandalism or arson that occurred on this establishment's premises either as a percentage of total annual sales or as total annual losses?

	Percent
Losses as percentage of total annual sales	**i4a** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

PROVIDE EITHER ONE OR THE OTHER, NOT BOTH

	LCUs
Total annual value of losses	**i4b**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

November 10, 2009	Indicator created.
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, i4a, i4b

Back to List of Indicators

CRIME

[crime2] Average security costs (% of annual sales)

Description

Average security costs as a percentage of total annual sales for all firms.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variables I.1 and I.2. If the respondent answered I2b, then the total cost is divided by annual sales (D2).

I.1	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, did this establishment pay for security, for example equipment, personnel, or professional security services?

Yes	1	
No	2	***GO TO QUESTION I.3***
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**	***GO TO QUESTION I.3***
		i1

I.2	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's total annual sales was paid for security, or what was the total annual cost of security?

	Percent
Percentage of total annual sales for security	**i2a** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

PROVIDE EITHER ONE OR THE OTHER, NOT BOTH

	LCUs
Total annual cost of security	**i2b**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Summer 2009	Outlier Program Change #1 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, i2a, i2b
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, i2a, i2b
May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

CRIME

[crime2_c] If the establishment pays for security, average security costs (% of annual sales)

Description

Average security costs as a percentage of total annual sales for firms that pay for security.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable I.2. If the respondent answered I2b, then the total cost is divided by annual sales (D2).

I.2	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of this establishment's total annual sales was paid for security, or what was the total annual cost of security?

	Percent
Percentage of total annual sales for security	**i2a** %
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

PROVIDE EITHER ONE OR THE OTHER, NOT BOTH

	LCUs
Total annual cost of security	**i2b**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**

Notes

Indicator Updates

November 10, 2009	Indicator Created
November 18, 2010	Outlier Program Change #2 affected outlier treatment on the variables d2, i2a, i2b

Back to List of Indicators

CRIME

[crime5] Average value of products shipped to supply domestic markets that were lost due to theft (% of product value)*

Description

Value of losses of products, due to theft, while in transit to domestic markets, as a percentage of product values shipped to supply domestic markets. This is computed only for manufacturing firms.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable D.10.

D.10	In fiscal year **[insert last complete fiscal year]**, what percentage of the value of products this establishment shipped to supply domestic markets was lost while in transit because of theft?

	Percent
Losses due to theft as percentage of the value of the products	**d10** %
No losses	**0**
Don't know (spontaneous)	**-9**
No internal shipments made	**-7**

Notes

Indicator Updates

Back to List of Indicator

CRIME

[crime8] Percent of firms identifying crime, theft and disorder as a major or very severe constraint

Description

Percentage of firms identifying crime, theft and disorder as a "major" or "very severe" obstacle. In particular, the coding conventions are as follows: i30==3 or 4 is coded as 100; i30 ==0 or 1 or 2 is coded as 0.

Survey Variable Used to Construct Indicator

This indicator is created from the variable I.30.

I.30	Using the response options on the card; To what degree is **Crime, Theft and Disorder** an obstacle to the current operations of this establishment? **SHOW CARD 15**

	No obstacle	Minor obstacle	Moderate obstacle	Major Obstacle	Very Severe Obstacle	**Do Not Know (spontaneous)**	**Does Not Apply (spontaneous)**
Crime, theft and disorder **i30**	0	1	2	3	4	**-9**	**-7**

Notes

For BEEPS surveys conducted prior to 2008, this question used a four-point scale instead of the current five-point answer scale. "Very Severe Obstacle" was not an answer option.

Indicator Updates

May 2, 2011	Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 surveys

Back to List of Indicators

DESCRIPTIONS OF INDICATOR UPDATES

Outlier Program Change 1 (Summer 2009)

Background: Data collected by the Enterprise Surveys Unit is cleaned as it is collected and checked against a number of quality controls. However, not all data presented through the Enterprise Surveys website is collected by the Enterprise Surveys Unit. For a series of variables, outlier values are identified and removed before the variable is used to construct indicators. A conservative approach is used in this analysis and researchers may wish to use their own techniques to identify outliers by accessing the original raw-data files and performing their own analysis. Variables collected with a response scale form 0% to 100% (e.g. Senior management's time spent on dealing with regulations) are subjected to trimming at plus and minus three standard deviations from the mean. Variables collected with unbounded responses (e.g. Total annual sales figures or Days to obtain an import license) are first log-transformed before being trimmed at plus and minus three standard deviations from the mean.

Change: For variables affected by this change, outlier analysis is performed on the log transformation of the variable. In previous versions of outlier programs, 0.0001 was added to zero values. After the change, 1 is added to all values before performing outlier analysis on the log value. This change was done to preserve zero values when running outlier analysis on logs. Performing the outlier analysis by survey, log values greater (less) than three times the standard deviation from the mean are considered outliers and replaced with a missing value.

Outlier Program Change 2 (November 18, 2010)
Outlier analysis was previously run at the country level. With the addition of new surveys and multiple surveys in the same country, outlier analysis is now run at the survey level.

Indicator Minus Value Change (December 7, 2010)
For the construction of some corruption indicators, negative values (-8 and -9) are changed to extended missing (.a or .b) and are no longer included in the outlier analysis.

Changes to ECA 2002 & 2005 Surveys (May 2, 2011)
The Enterprise Surveys team has made a change to indicators computed for the 2002 and 2005 rounds of surveys conducted in Europe and Central Asia (ECA). This change reflects the exclusion of observations in some sectors in an effort to improve comparability of these data with the more recent rounds of survey collection.

Refusal response incorporation for corr2 indicator (May 1, 2014)
The Enterprise Surveys team has made a correction to the corr2 indicator. Due to some error in the code corr2 did not include refusals to the variable j6. This has now been corrected.

Change of denominator for gend3 indicator (Feb 3, 2014)
The Enterprise Surveys team has made a correction to the gend3 indicator. Inappropriate denominator was used to calculate gend3. This has now been corrected.

Creation of new indicator gend5 (Feb 3, 2014)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created a new indicator gend5 in topic for gender.

Removal of out of date indicators (May 29, 2014)
Indicators that were out of date have been removed from ES website.

Creation of new indicator perf4 (Nov 11, 2014)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created a new indicator perf4 in topic for performance.

Creation of new indicator gend6 (Aug 20, 2015)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created a new indicator gend6 in topic for gender.

Methodology change in indicators perf1 and perf3 (Dec 15, 2016)
The Enterprise Surveys team has decided to deflate sales values using the country-level GDP deflators instead of converting them to USD and then deflating using the US GDP deflator.

Creation of 12 new indicators (June 26, 2017)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created 12 new indicators: reg6 for regulation and taxes, fin22 for finance, in16 and in17 for infrastructure, tr17 and tr16 for trade, car7 and car 8 for firm characteristics, and lastly t7, t8, t9, and t10 for innovation and technology.

Creation of 6 new indicators (August 7, 2017)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created 6 new indicators: wk14, wk15, wk16, wk17, wk18, and wk19 on the topic of workforce.

Methodology change in perf1 and perf3 (September 11, 2017)
GDP deflators are now adjusted for the structure of each firm's fiscal year. In particular, we use the closing month of the firms' fiscal year to weigh the annual deflators from WDI accordingly.

Methodology change in t10 (January 30, 2023)
The indicator is restricted to establishments with 20 or more employees.

Creation of 9 new indicators (May 15, 2023)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created 9 new indicators: mgmt1-mgmt9 on the topic of management practices.

Creation of 3 new indicators and a correction (June 26, 2023)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created 3 new indicators: fin23, fin24, and fin25, on the topic of credit constraints. Also, correction was made to handle r10 = -7 as described above, instead of inadvertently treating it as missing.

Correction to make an indicator manufacturing-only as originally intended (August 21, 2023)
The Enterprise Surveys team has made a correction to the tr1 indicator. Due to an error in the code tr1 did not exclude services sector. This has now been corrected.

Corrections to indicators gend2 gend3 gend5 in3 in3_c in4 in4_c in15 (June 3, 2024)
The Enterprise Surveys team has removed rounding to the nearest 0.5 from indicators gend2, gend3, gend5, in4 and in4_c. For in4 and in4_c, a coding typo was corrected to avoid inadvertently imputing 0s when the indicator

should not be calculated; and outlier routine was applied to the indicator itself, not the individual components. For indicators in3, in3_c and in15, the indicator is not calculated when one of the components (c8b) is "don't know".

Creation of 66 new indicators (July 5, 2024)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created 66 new indicators, spanning all the topics previously covered and adding several new (e.g., climate, dispute resolution). The new indicators also include the ones that feed into the first Business Ready (B-READY) report. All the indicators that feed into the B-READY report (including the previously existing WBES indicators) are marked with [B-READY] in the label of the corresponding variable.

The full list of newly created indicators is as follows: reg9 reg10 reg11 reg12 tax1 tax2 tax3 tax4 tax5 tax6 tax7 tax8 fin26 fin27 fin28 fin29 fin30 fin31 fin32 fin33 in18 in19 in20 in21 in22 in23 in24 in25 in26 gend7 gend8 gend9 tr18 tr19 tr20 tr21 tr22 tr23 tr24 tr25 tr26 comp1 comp2 comp3 comp4 comp5 comp6 comp7 comp8 comp9 disp1 disp2 disp3 disp4 disp5 disp6 wk20 wk21 wk22 wk23 wk24 wk25 wk26 wk27 wk28 t11.

Corrections to indicators tr1 tr18 tr2 tr21 tr23 tr24 (July 21, 2025)
The Enterprise Surveys team has corrected several trade indicators: for tr1 and tr18, we now exclude cases where export customs clearance time (d4) exceeds total border clearance (d33), with tr18 additionally excluding sub-daily clearances (d33a <1 day) lacking hourly data (d33b); for tr2 and tr24, we excluded cases where import customs time (d14) exceeds total border clearance (d40); and for tr23, calculations now use the disaggregated d14a (days) and d14b (hours). We detected an error in the computation of tr21, and corrected for it to be based on d12b instead of d13, as originally intended.

Scale modifications for 10 indicators (September 22, 2025)
The Enterprise Survey team has modified the scale from ascending (i.e., high is better) to descending (i.e., higher is worse) of 10 perception-based indicators in order to better align with previous perception WBES indicators. More specifically, for the indicators reg12, fin33, in23, tr26, disp6, and wk28, the scale assignment has been modified so that 0 is currently assigned for "no obstacle", 25 for "minor" obstacle, 50 for "moderate" obstacle, 75 for "major" obstacle, and 100 for "very severe" obstacle. For the indicators disp3, disp4 and disp5, the scale assignment has been modified so that 0 is now assigned for "strongly" or "tend to" agree, and 100 for "strongly" or "tend to" disagree. For the indicator comp9, the scale assignment has been modified so that 0 is now assigned for "not difficult at all", 33 for "somewhat difficult", 66 for "moderately difficult", and 100 for "very difficult".

Creation of 4 new indicators (September 22, 2025)
The Enterprise Surveys team has created 4 new indicators: 2 under the trade topic and 2 under the innovation topic. For the trade topic, new indicators, tr18_u and tr24_u, are somewhat similar to the existing tr18 and tr24, respectively, but handle a "does not apply" response differently. For innovation, the new indicators, t7_ml and t9_ml, are calculated specifically for the subset of medium or large firms.

Changes to indicators tr1, tr18, tr2, tr23, tr24, and wk27 (September 22, 2025)
The Enterprise Surveys team has modified five trade indicators and one workforce indicator. Indicators tr1, tr2, and tr23 measure the time for customs control agencies. When d4a or d14a, respectively, is less than a day but the answer to the question about hours is "don't know", one day is assigned for backward consistency (instead

of excluding from calculations). Similarly, for indicator wk27, when it takes less than a month to resolve a labor dispute (l38a) and an answer in terms of days (l38b) is "don't know", the value 1 is assigned to l38, for backward consistency. Indicators tr18 and tr24 measure the time for all border control agencies, with hours being considered since inception. When d33a or d40a, respectively, is less than a day but the answer to the question about hours is "don't know", half-day is assigned (instead of excluding from calculations).

Correction to indicators gend8 and gend9 (December 15, 2025)
The Enterprise Surveys team has corrected the code for gend8 and gend9 indicators. The data from variable l12a1 had been inadvertently converted into shares, rather than percentages. This has now been corrected by applying the appropriate multiplication by 100.

Publication of 9 new indicators on the WBES country pages (January 26, 2026)
The Enterprise Surveys team has introduced nine new Jobs indicators to the WBES country pages (variables jobs1 through jobs9). These indicators focus on four key dimensions: the distribution of jobs across firm characteristics (such as size and sector), job expansion, job contraction, and net job change. Unlike other WBES indicators described in this document, the Jobs indicators are aggregate measures and are not available at the firm level; accordingly, they are not included in the firm-level databases. For the same reason, standard errors are not reported, as estimating them at the scale of the WBES is computationally prohibitive.

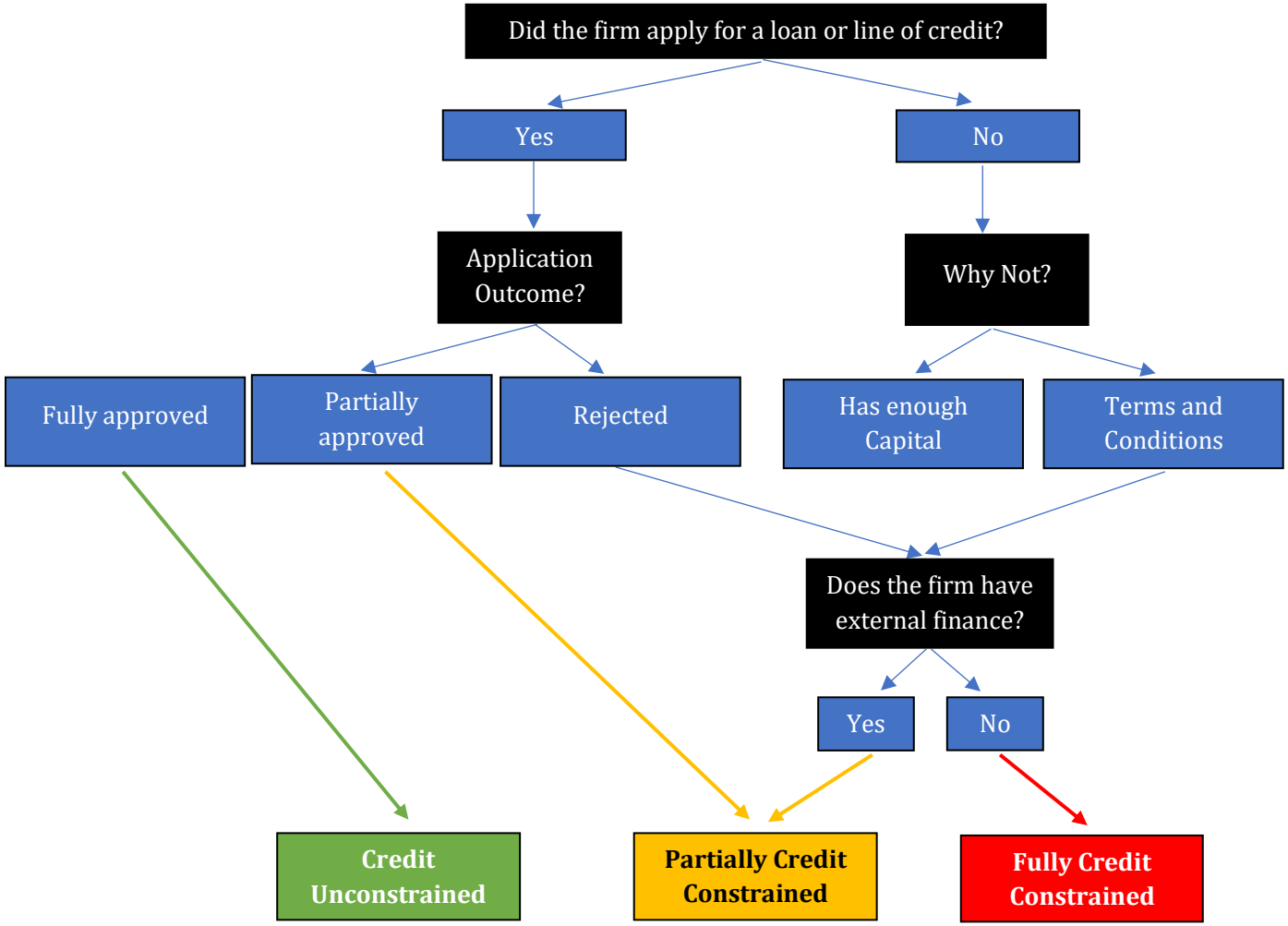
Correction to indicator wk23 (April 1, 2026)
The Enterprise Surveys team has updated the code for the indicator wk23 to incorporate ratio of l9b1 (number of permanent full time workers who completed at least secondary school) to l1 (total number of permanent full time workers) in cases where this information was not originally reported in percentage form (l9b).

Creation of a new indicator (June 4, 2026)
The Enterprise Surveys team has introduced a new indicator, reg13, under Regulations topic. This indicator measures the average duration (in days, for each firm) required to obtain five key services: an import license (bus1), an operating license (bus2), a construction-related permit (bus3), an electrical connection (in1), and a water connection (in5).

Creation of a new indicator (July 24, 2026)
The Enterprise Surveys team has introduced a new indicator, fin34, under Finance topic. This indicator measures the percentage of firms that are partially or fully credit constrained (combing indicators fin23 and fin24).

Back to List of Indicators

APPENDIX


Did the firm apply for a loan or line of credit?
Yes
No
Application Outcome?
Why Not?
Fully approved
Partially approved
Rejected
Has enough Capital
Terms and Conditions
Does the firm have external finance?
Yes
No
Credit Unconstrained
Partially Credit Constrained
Fully Credit Constrained